

Simtora Technologies, Inc.

Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual

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Applies to	All directors, officers and employees of Simtora Technologies, Inc. and its subsidiaries in Pakistan, Germany, France, Australia and the United Kingdom ("Simtora" or "the Company"), wherever they work; contractors, consultants, interns, agency workers and other third parties acting for Simtora, as their contracts provide
Related manuals	Human Resources Policy Manual (SIM-HR-001); Global People Supplement (SIM-HR-002); International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001, Part 2); IT Policy Manual (SIM-IT-001); Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001); Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001); Facilities and Office Administration Manual (SIM-FAC-001)

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Introduction

This manual sets out the ethical standards and legal rules that govern how everyone at Simtora Technologies, Inc. does business. It covers honesty in our records and dealings, fair competition, conflicts of interest, anti-corruption, trade rules, privacy and responsible technology, and, above all, how to raise a concern safely. It is the central reference for the Code of Ethics, and it is where other Simtora manuals send you for those topics.

Our ethical commitments

Simtora will:

1. **Obey the law** in every place we do business, and follow the spirit of the rules as well as the letter.
2. **Be honest** with customers, colleagues, partners, regulators, investors and the public, and keep records that tell the truth.
3. **Compete on merit.** We win business with better products and service, never with bribes, deception or agreements with competitors.
4. **Protect the trust placed in us.** Customers, employees and partners give us data and confidences; we guard them.
5. **Build technology responsibly,** with attention to privacy, fairness, safety and the people affected by what we make.
6. **Speak up and listen.** Anyone can raise a concern without fear of retaliation, and we act on what we hear.
7. **Hold everyone to the same standard,** from a new hire to the CEO.

How to use this manual

- **Status of this manual.** This manual states the Company's standards. It is not a contract of employment and does not change at-will employment (see HR 1.2). It is a condition of working at Simtora that you follow it.
- **It cannot cover everything.** No manual can anticipate every situation. Use it with your judgment; when in doubt, ask (see 1.3).
- **Changes.** The Compliance Officer publishes revisions on the intranet with notice to employees. The intranet version is always current.
- **Conflicts.** Where this manual conflicts with applicable law, the law governs. Where state or local law is stricter than this manual, follow the stricter rule. Where this manual is stricter than the law, follow this manual.
- **Relationship to other manuals.** This manual is the primary source for ethics, anti-corruption, conflicts of interest, competition law, sanctions, privacy governance, records and legal holds. It does not repeat the HR rules on harassment and discipline, the IT rules on security, or the Finance and Procurement rules on approvals; it points to them.
- **Questions.** Ask your manager first, or contact Compliance at compliance@simtora.example.

Locations outside the United States

The Code applies in full to the San Francisco headquarters and to the R&D centers in Lahore, Berlin, Paris, Sydney and London. The standards are the same everywhere; where local law is stricter, the stricter rule applies. The **International Operations Supplement (SIM-GLB-001), Part 2** lists the local laws that matter most for each country: anti-bribery (including the UK Bribery Act and the French Sapin II law), privacy (GDPR, UK GDPR, the Australian Privacy Act and the position in Pakistan), local whistleblower laws and their deadlines, sanctions and export controls, government inspections, and record keeping. References in this manual to U.S. law (for example, "state law" or U.S. agencies) are examples; employees outside the U.S. apply the equivalent local rule given in the Supplement. Gift and expense limits in this manual are stated in U.S. dollars and apply in their local-currency equivalent.

Roles and responsibilities (summary)

Role	Main responsibilities under this manual
Everyone	Read and follow this manual; complete training and certification on time; ask when unsure; report concerns promptly; cooperate truthfully with reviews and investigations.
Managers	Lead by example; make it safe to raise concerns; pass on any concern they hear within 1 business day; never retaliate; check that their teams complete training; escalate conflicts and gifts requests.
Compliance Officer	Runs the compliance program day to day; maintains registers and training; advises on questions; triages and coordinates investigations; reports to the General Counsel and, at least quarterly, to the Audit Committee. Has direct access to the Audit Committee chair.
General Counsel	Owens this manual; interprets the law; directs legal holds and government interactions; approves high-risk matters; sits on the Compliance Committee.
Chief People Officer / HR	Handles harassment, discrimination and workplace conduct matters (HR 3.2); supports corrective action; keeps personnel records; co-owns conflicts involving employment.
CFO / Finance	Accuracy of books and records; internal controls; payment controls that prevent improper payments; supports investigations involving funds.
Head of IT / CISO	Security of systems and data; evidence preservation and legal-hold implementation; supports privacy and AI governance.
Head of Procurement and Business Owners	Vendor due diligence; conflicts in sourcing; keeping third parties to Simtora standards.
Executive Team	Sets the tone; approves the program and resources; hears escalated matters; is bound by the same rules.
CEO	Final approval of this manual; approves waivers for non-executive matters; ultimately accountable to the Board for the

Part 1 – Our Ethical Foundation

1.1 Code of Ethics and Company Values

Purpose. To state the values that guide decisions at Simtora and the ethical baseline that every policy in this manual builds on.

Scope. Everyone in scope of this manual (see 1.2), in every part of the business and in every location, including remote work.

Our values

Value	What it means in practice
Integrity	We tell the truth, keep our word, admit mistakes early and do the right thing when no one is watching. Integrity is not limited to money: it covers honesty in code, data, marketing claims and how we treat people.
Customer trust	Customers rely on us with their data and their operations. We protect that trust in how we build, secure and support our products, and we do not overpromise.
Ownership	We take responsibility for our work and its consequences, including for the people who use our products and for the decisions of the teams we lead.
Craft	We build well and take pride in quality, security and reliability. We do not cut corners in ways that could harm others or hide the shortcut.
Respect and inclusion	We treat each other, customers and partners with dignity, value different perspectives and create a workplace where everyone can do their best work.
Openness	We share information appropriately, welcome challenge and questions, and let people raise concerns without fear.

The Code of Ethics in brief

Every person at Simtora commits to:

1. Comply with the law and with Company policy.
2. Act honestly and ethically, including in the handling of actual or apparent conflicts of interest.
3. Keep accurate records and give full, fair, accurate, timely and understandable information to auditors, regulators and the public where Simtora communicates with them.
4. Protect confidential information, personal data and Company assets.
5. Deal fairly with customers, suppliers, competitors and colleagues.
6. Refuse bribes and improper payments, and refuse to take part in dishonest conduct, even if a manager or customer asks.

7. Report suspected violations promptly and never retaliate against anyone who does.
8. Cooperate with reviews, audits and investigations, and tell the truth.

Every provision in the rest of this manual applies these commitments to particular situations.

1.2 Who Must Follow This Manual

Purpose. To make clear who is bound and how the manual reaches people who are not employees.

Employees, officers and directors

- Every employee, officer and director must follow this manual, in every location and in every work arrangement (office, hybrid, remote, travel, customer sites).
- Directors and members of the Executive Team are held to the same standards and, for some matters (conflicts, related-party transactions, waivers), to additional ones.

Contractors, consultants, agency workers and interns

- Contractors, consultants, agency workers and interns must follow the parts of this manual that apply to their work. Contracts or assignment letters say so.
- Managers who engage them must tell them about the manual, tell them how to report concerns, and give them any training required by their access or role (see 6.2).

Third parties acting for Simtora

Agents, resellers, distributors, consultants, lobbyists, customs brokers, sales partners and others who act on Simtora's behalf or interact with government or customers for us must:

- agree in the contract to comply with applicable anti-corruption, sanctions, privacy and competition laws, and with the Supplier and Partner Standards (see 5.5);
- pass the due diligence in 6.5 before engagement; and
- allow reasonable audit and accept termination for breach.

Manager duties

Managers are in the best position to build an ethical culture. A manager must:

- Set the tone: explain expectations, talk about ethics in team meetings at least once a quarter, and never pressure anyone to break a rule or "hit the number at any cost."
- Make it safe to raise concerns: listen, thank the person, and never retaliate or allow others to.
- **Pass on every concern** about a possible violation of this manual, the law or Company policy to Compliance, HR or Legal within **1 business day**, even if the person says it is minor or asks the manager not to. Managers do not investigate alone.
- Protect confidentiality: share only with those who need to know.
- Make sure their team completes assigned training and certification on time.
- Not approve a request they have a conflict on, and raise conflicts they learn about.

Personal accountability

No one may justify a violation by saying a manager instructed it, that "everyone does it," that it benefits the Company, or that it will not be found out. Instructions to break the law or this manual must be refused and reported. Employees who refuse in good faith are protected (see 2.3).

1.3 Making Ethical Decisions and Asking Questions

Purpose. To give a simple method for hard calls and to show where to get help fast.

The five-question test

When a situation is unclear, ask:

1. **Is it legal?** Does it comply with the law and with Company policy?
2. **Is it honest?** Would it mislead anyone, even by leaving things out?
3. **Is it fair?** Does it treat customers, colleagues, suppliers and competitors as we would want to be treated?
4. **Could I explain it?** Would I be comfortable if my manager, a customer, a regulator or a news reporter saw exactly what I did and why?
5. **Does it feel right?** If something feels off, stop and ask.

If any answer is "no" or "not sure," pause and ask for help before you act.

Where to get help

Question or concern	First contact	Other options
Not sure whether something is allowed	Your manager	Compliance (compliance@simtora.example); Legal
Gifts, meals, entertainment	Compliance	Your Department Head
Conflict of interest	Your manager and Compliance	HR
Possible bribery, sanctions or export issue	Compliance or Legal, before acting	General Counsel
Privacy or data question	Legal / Privacy lead	IT Security (security@simtora.example)
Harassment, discrimination, retaliation	HR (hr@simtora.example)	Ethics Line; Chief People Officer
Suspected fraud, accounting or audit concern	Ethics Line (ethics@simtora.example)	Audit Committee (audit@simtora.example)
Any concern you are uncomfortable raising with your chain	Ethics Line	Compliance Officer; General Counsel; Audit Committee

Compliance aims to answer routine questions within **2 business days**. Urgent questions (for example, a proposal that will be signed today) should be marked urgent and will be answered the same business day where possible.

Escalation

A concern that is not resolved at one level moves up: employee, manager, Department Head, Compliance Officer or General Counsel, CEO. Matters involving the Executive Team, the CEO, the General Counsel, or the Compliance function go to the Audit Committee (see 2.4).

1.4 Compliance Program Governance

Purpose. To describe how Simtora runs an effective compliance and ethics program that meets the expectations of U.S. law and regulators, including the U.S. Department of Justice's guidance on evaluating corporate compliance programs and the U.S. Sentencing Guidelines.

Scope. All compliance areas in this manual.

The elements of the program

Element	What Simtora does	Section
Standards and procedures	Written code and policies, regularly updated	This manual
Oversight and resources	Board oversight; a Compliance Officer with authority, independence and budget	1.4
Risk assessment	Annual risk assessment used to focus effort	6.1
Training and communication	Role-based training and regular messages	6.2
Reporting and investigation	Ethics Line, non-retaliation, prompt and fair investigations	Part 2
Third-party management	Risk-based due diligence and contract terms	6.5
Monitoring and testing	Controls testing, audits, data analytics	6.4
Incentives and discipline	Consistent consequences; ethics part of performance	6.8
Continuous improvement	Lessons learned; program review each year	6.9

Governance structure

Body or role	Composition and role
Board and Audit Committee	The Board oversees the program. The Audit Committee receives at least quarterly reports from the Compliance Officer and General Counsel, reviews the Ethics Line log, hears any report about the Executive Team or accounting matters, and approves the annual compliance plan.
Compliance Committee	Chaired by the General Counsel; members are the Compliance Officer, CFO, Chief People Officer, Head of IT / CISO, Head of Procurement, and a rotating Department Head. Meets quarterly (monthly during a major investigation or program launch). Reviews risks, incidents, training results and policy changes.
General Counsel	Owns this manual and the compliance program. Reports to the CEO with unfettered access to the Board and Audit Committee.
Compliance Officer	Reports to the General Counsel for administration and directly to the Audit Committee for oversight. Runs the program, maintains registers and the training calendar, manages the Ethics Line intake, and coordinates investigations. Cannot be removed or have compensation changed without Audit Committee involvement.
Compliance Champions	At least one designated manager in each department who supports training, answers routine questions and relays concerns to Compliance.

Independence and resources

- The Compliance Officer has **direct access to the Audit Committee chair** at any time and holds a private session with the Audit Committee at least **twice a year** without management present.
- The General Counsel and CEO give the Compliance Officer the budget, tools and staff needed to run the program. Resourcing is reviewed annually by the Audit Committee.
- Compliance decisions are made on the facts and the law and are not subject to commercial pressure.

Conflicts within the compliance function

Any concern about the Compliance Officer or General Counsel, or any matter in which either has a personal interest, goes directly to the Audit Committee chair (audit@simtora.example).

Part 2 – Speaking Up

2.1 The Duty to Speak Up and How to Report

Purpose. To make it clear that Simtora wants to hear concerns early and to give safe, easy ways to raise them.

Scope. Everyone in scope of this manual, and anyone outside the Company (customers, vendors, former employees) with a concern about Simtora.

The duty

- **Everyone** must promptly report any actual or suspected violation of law, this manual or Company policy that they become aware of, and any request to do something that seems unethical or unlawful.
- **Managers** must additionally pass reports on as required in 1.2.
- Reporting late is better than not reporting. Doing nothing, or covering up, is itself a violation.
- You do not have to be certain. Report what you honestly believe and what you have seen; do not investigate yourself, confront the person, or gather evidence in ways that break security rules.

What to report (examples)

- Fraud, false records, improper revenue recognition or expense claims, side agreements not disclosed to Finance.
- Bribes, kickbacks, improper gifts or payments to anyone, including government officials.
- Conflicts of interest that have not been disclosed.

- Price-fixing, bid-rigging, sharing sensitive information with competitors, agreements not to hire or to fix wages.
- Violations of sanctions, export controls or anti-money laundering rules.
- Data privacy or security breaches, misuse of personal data or concealment of an incident.
- Misuse of AI that harms people or breaks law or policy.
- Discrimination, harassment, retaliation, unsafe conditions or threats of violence.
- Theft, misuse of Company or customer assets, or falsified timesheets or records.
- Retaliation against anyone who reported a concern or took part in an investigation.
- Attempts to hide or destroy evidence.

Ways to report

Channel	When to use it
Your manager or Department Head	Ordinary concerns you are comfortable raising in your reporting line.
HR (hr@simtora.example) or the Chief People Officer	Workplace conduct, harassment, discrimination, retaliation.
Compliance (compliance@simtora.example) or the Compliance Officer	Any ethics or compliance matter; questions about the Code.
General Counsel or Legal	Legal risk, government contact, urgent matters.
Ethics Line (ethics@simtora.example , and the secure web form on the intranet)	Any matter, especially where you want anonymity or are uncomfortable using other channels.
Audit Committee (audit@simtora.example)	Accounting, internal control, audit or financial reporting concerns; concerns about the Executive Team, General Counsel or Compliance Officer.
Government agencies	At any time, without notice to or permission from Simtora (see 2.5).

Choose whichever channel you trust. **Never report to a person you believe is involved in the matter.** If you report through a channel that is not the right one, that person must forward it to Compliance within 1 business day.

What to include

The more detail, the faster we can act: what happened, who was involved, when and where, how you know, whether there is evidence (documents, messages, logs), and whether it is still going on. Appendix D lists the details, but you do not need every one to report.

2.2 The Ethics Line and Confidentiality

Purpose. To describe how the Ethics Line works and how reporters' identities are protected.

How it works

- The Ethics Line is a confidential channel for reporting concerns. It is available at any time by email (ethics@simtora.example) and through a secure web form hosted by an independent third party that allows a reporter to remain **anonymous** and still receive follow-up questions and updates through the platform.
- Reports are read only by the Compliance Officer and the General Counsel (or, for matters involving them or the Executive Team, by the Audit Committee chair). Access to the log is restricted and recorded.
- Simtora accepts **anonymous reports** and reviews them on the seriousness, credibility and verifiability of the information. Anonymous reporters are encouraged to keep checking the platform for questions.

Confidentiality

- Reporter identity and the content of a report are shared **only with those who need to know** to review, investigate, or take action, or as the law requires.
- People who work on an investigation must keep it confidential. Discussing an investigation outside of the need-to-know group may lead to corrective action. This does not prevent anyone from exercising the rights in 2.5.

- Simtora cannot promise absolute confidentiality: sometimes the facts point to the reporter, or law or legal process requires disclosure. Where that happens, the reporter is told first whenever possible.
- No one may try to identify an anonymous reporter, and attempts to do so (including technical tracing) are violations of this manual.

Data protection

Ethics Line records are kept in a restricted system, retained for **7 years** after the case closes (longer under a legal hold), and then deleted. Personal data in reports is handled under 4.1.

2.3 Non-Retaliation

Purpose. To protect people who speak up in good faith.

The rule

Simtora **prohibits retaliation** against anyone who, in good faith:

- reports a concern, asks a question about ethics or compliance, or refuses to take part in conduct they reasonably believe is unlawful or a violation of this manual;
- takes part in or supports an investigation, audit, or proceeding; or
- reports to a government agency or exercises any right in 2.5.

Retaliation includes dismissal, demotion, suspension, pay or bonus reductions, less favorable assignments or schedules, exclusion, threats, harassment, negative references, reporting immigration status, and any other action that would discourage a reasonable person from speaking up. Retaliation is serious misconduct, and in many cases also a violation of law (for example, under the Sarbanes-Oxley Act, the Dodd-Frank Act, the False Claims Act, Title VII and state whistleblower laws).

Good faith

A report is made in good faith if the reporter honestly believes it is true, even if it turns out to be mistaken. No action is taken against someone whose report is not substantiated.

Knowingly false or malicious reports may lead to corrective action.

What to do if you experience retaliation

1. Report it immediately to HR, Compliance, Legal, the Ethics Line or the Audit Committee. Retaliation reports are treated as high priority.
2. Compliance opens a case within **2 business days**, protects the person from further harm (for example, by reviewing pending employment decisions), and reviews the matter as an investigation under 2.4.
3. Any adverse employment decision involving an employee who has raised a concern in the past **12 months** requires review by HR and Compliance before it takes effect, to check that it is unrelated to the report.

Managers

Managers who retaliate, or who permit retaliation, will face corrective action up to and including termination. Managers must never ask "who reported this?"

2.4 Investigations

Purpose. To make sure every report is reviewed promptly, fairly and consistently, by the right people, with proper records.

Scope. All reports of possible violations of law, this manual or Company policy. Harassment and discrimination complaints follow HR 3.2 and its timescales; the Compliance Officer is informed of all such reports.

Principles

- **Prompt and proportionate.** The effort should match the seriousness of the allegation.
- **Independent and impartial.** The investigator has no stake in the outcome and does not report to anyone involved.
- **Fair.** The person accused is told the allegation at the right time, given a chance to respond, and presumed to have acted properly until the facts show otherwise.
- **Confidential.** Information is shared only on a need-to-know basis.
- **Documented.** Scope, evidence, interviews, findings and decisions are recorded.

- **Legally protected where appropriate.** Legal directs investigations that may lead to legal action, regulatory exposure or significant financial impact so that privilege applies where possible.

Process and timescales

Step	What happens	Who	Target time
1. Intake and logging	Report received, logged with a case number, conflicts checked	Compliance Officer	Within 2 business days
2. Acknowledgement	Reporter told the report was received (where contact is possible)	Compliance Officer	Within 5 business days
3. Triage	Classify by severity; decide who investigates; check whether legal hold or urgent protective measures are needed	Compliance Officer and General Counsel	Within 5 business days
4. Escalation of serious matters	Matters involving fraud, senior leaders, government exposure, accounting, safety or possible data breach are reported to the General Counsel, CEO and Audit Committee chair	Compliance Officer	Within 24 hours of triage
5. Investigation	Plan, preserve evidence, interview, review records	Investigator (Compliance, HR, Internal Audit, or outside counsel)	Aim to complete within 45 days (90 days for complex or multi-jurisdiction matters); longer if needed with the reason recorded

decision	Written findings; substantiated / not substantiated / inconclusive; recommended remedies	Investigator to Compliance Officer and General Counsel	Within 10 business days of finishing interviews
7. Action	Corrective action, process fixes, notifications (see 2.6)	Managers with HR, Legal	Within 10 business days of the decision
8. Feedback	Reporter (and subject) told the matter is closed, to the extent possible	Compliance Officer	At closure
9. Closure and lessons	Case closed with root cause; program changes recorded	Compliance Officer	At closure

Who investigates

Type of matter	Lead
Harassment, discrimination, workplace conduct	HR (HR 3.2), with Compliance informed
Policy breach, conflicts, gifts, procurement, expense misuse	Compliance, with Finance or Procurement support
Accounting, financial reporting, fraud, or matters over \$50,000	General Counsel with the CFO (or Audit Committee's chosen investigator), outside counsel or forensic accountants as needed
Security or privacy incidents involving misconduct	Security with Legal (see IT 7.4)
Anything involving the Executive Team, CEO, General Counsel, CFO or Compliance function	Audit Committee through outside counsel
Anything involving Compliance staff	General Counsel or Audit Committee chair

Rights and duties in an investigation

- **Cooperation is required.** Employees must cooperate and give truthful and complete information, and must not destroy or alter records or discuss testimony to influence others.
- **Interview rights.** The investigator explains that they act for the Company (and that the interview is confidential) at the start of each interview. Employees may raise concerns about the process with Compliance.
- **Support.** Employees involved (reporters, witnesses and subjects) can use the Employee Assistance Program (see HR 4.4).
- **Records.** Case files are kept in a restricted system and retained per 2.2.
- **Evidence.** Legal issues legal holds as needed and IT preserves data (see 4.4). Any device or account review must follow IT 4.8 and be approved by the General Counsel and Chief People Officer.

Conflicts and recusal

No one investigates a matter in which they, a family member, a close friend, a direct report or their own manager is involved. Anyone with a conflict must tell Compliance immediately and step aside.

2.5 Protected Rights and Reports to Government

Purpose. To make sure nothing in Simtora's policies or agreements stops anyone from exercising their legal rights.

Nothing in this manual, in any other Simtora policy, or in any confidentiality, separation, non-disclosure or other agreement prohibits or restricts anyone from:

- reporting possible violations of law or regulation to, filing a charge or complaint with, communicating with, or taking part in an investigation or proceeding by any federal, state or local government agency, without notice to or approval from Simtora (for example the SEC, DOJ, EEOC, NLRB, OSHA, Department of Labor, FTC, state attorneys general, or Congress);

- receiving an award for information provided to a government agency (for example an SEC whistleblower award);
- making disclosures protected by whistleblower laws;
- discussing or disclosing wages, hours, benefits or working conditions, or acting together with others for mutual aid or protection;
- speaking about, or disclosing information about, unlawful acts in the workplace such as harassment, discrimination or other conduct that the employee has reason to believe is unlawful (including as protected by the Speak Out Act and state law);
- testifying truthfully in any legal proceeding; or
- disclosing a trade secret in the circumstances protected by the Defend Trade Secrets Act (see HR 1.8).

Legal review of agreements. Legal reviews every confidentiality, separation and non-disclosure template at least annually to confirm that it contains these carve-outs, and it must not include terms that require an employee to tell Simtora about, or to waive an award for, a report to a government agency.

Attorney-client privilege. This section does not require anyone to disclose privileged communications with Simtora's lawyers, and Simtora does not waive privilege by any policy statement. Employees who are asked to share privileged material should ask Legal first.

2.6 Outcomes, Remedies and Self-Reporting

Purpose. To ensure that investigations lead to fixes, not just findings.

Outcomes

Finding	Typical response
Substantiated	Corrective action under HR 2.3 and 6.8 here, based on severity, intent, cooperation and history; repair of harm (repayment, correcting records, restoring a wrongly-denied benefit); control or training fixes
Not substantiated	

Remediation

Every substantiated case has a written **remediation plan** (owner, action, due date).

Common actions: recovery of funds, notification of affected customers, correction of financial statements or filings, process redesign, additional monitoring, training for the team, changes to third-party arrangements. Compliance tracks each action to completion and reports overdue actions to the Compliance Committee.

Self-reporting and disclosure to authorities

- An employee who reports their own involvement in a violation is not exempt from corrective action, but prompt self-reporting is a significant mitigating factor.
 - **Legal decides** whether to report a matter to a regulator, law enforcement, a customer or an insurer. Decisions must consider legal duties (for example federal contractor mandatory disclosure rules in 3.9, securities and breach notification rules, and contractual duties) and cooperation credit under DOJ and agency policies.
 - The **Audit Committee** is told about every voluntary or required disclosure to a government authority before it is made, or, where timing does not permit, as soon as possible afterward.
 - Insurance notices (for example, D&O, cyber and crime policies) are made promptly by the CFO on Legal's advice.
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Part 3 – Integrity in Business Dealings

3.1 Accurate Books, Records and Financial Reporting

Purpose. To make sure Simtora's records are complete and accurate, so that decisions made on them, and statements made to customers, lenders, auditors, investors and regulators, are reliable.

Scope. All employees. Not only Finance: sales bookings, timesheets, expense claims, project status reports, security attestations, customer usage data, support tickets and product metrics are all Company records.

Policy

- **Accuracy.** Every record must fairly and accurately describe the transaction or fact, in reasonable detail, with the supporting documents.
- **No false or misleading entries.** Never make, ask someone to make, or allow a false, incomplete, backdated or misleading entry, or a document that hides the true nature of a transaction.
- **No undisclosed funds or assets.** All money and assets are recorded. Off-book accounts, "slush funds", and unrecorded liabilities are prohibited.
- **Payments only for their stated purpose.** No payment may be approved or made with the understanding that any part will be used for something other than what the payment documents say.
- **Approvals and segregation.** Follow the approval limits and separation of duties in the Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001, 1.2 and 1.3). Do not split transactions to get under approval limits.
- **Revenue integrity.** Revenue is recognized only under the Company's revenue policy and applicable accounting standards. No side letters, oral promises, undisclosed rights of return, bill-and-hold arrangements, backdated contracts, or extended payment terms outside contract terms. Sales agreements that differ from the standard terms must go through the deal review process by Legal and Finance before signature. Any commitment that could affect revenue must be in the contract.
- **Estimates and judgments.** Forecasts, reserves and accruals must be made in good faith on the best information available. Pressure to "manage" numbers is a red flag and must be reported.
- **Timesheets and cost records.** Time and cost records, including those charged to customers or government contracts, must be accurate and charged to the correct project (see 3.9).
- **Auditors and regulators.** Never mislead, influence, coerce or manipulate an internal or external auditor. Give auditors complete, prompt and truthful answers and access to records. Never withhold information from them.
- **Internal controls.** Everyone follows internal controls. Finance tests key controls each year (see 6.4). Control failures must be reported when found, not concealed.
- **Retention.** Records are kept for the periods in 4.4; no record may be destroyed to prevent its use in an investigation, audit or proceeding.

Red flags to report

- Requests to backdate a document, change a date or amount after the fact, or delay recording an expense.
- Pressure to close a deal or recognize revenue before the conditions are met.
- Unexplained journal entries or adjustments near period end.
- Payments to unfamiliar parties or in unusual ways (cash, third-country accounts, split payments).
- Invoices with vague descriptions, round-dollar amounts, or lacking approvals.
- Reluctance to give auditors information.

Responsibilities

- **CFO:** owns the control environment and certifies financial statements to the Board, lenders and auditors as required.
 - **Finance:** operate and test controls; escalate anomalies to Compliance.
 - **Managers:** review the accuracy of records in their area.
 - **Everyone:** prepare records honestly and report errors when found.
-

3.2 Fair Dealing, Honest Selling and Truthful Marketing

Purpose. To make sure that Simtora wins and keeps business honestly, with claims that are true and fair.

Fair dealing

Deal fairly with customers, suppliers, competitors and colleagues. Never gain an advantage through manipulation, concealment, abuse of confidential information, misrepresentation of material facts, or other unfair practices.

Sales and contracting

- Describe products, services, roadmaps, pricing and performance **accurately**. Do not promise features, dates, security certifications or performance that have not been

approved by Product, Engineering, Security or Legal.

- Never make commitments outside the approved contract. All terms must be in writing and follow the deal-approval process. Non-standard security, privacy, liability or service commitments need review by Security and Legal (see IT 8.3 and Appendix H).
- Be clear about what is included, what is extra, and automatic renewal or price-increase terms. Comply with state auto-renewal and consumer-protection laws.
- Do not disparage competitors with statements you cannot support. Comparative claims need evidence on file.
- Do not exploit a customer's mistake (for example, a pricing error) without correcting it.

Marketing, advertising and public claims

- All advertising and marketing claims must be **truthful, not misleading, and substantiated** before they are made (Federal Trade Commission Act and state law).
- Claims about **AI capabilities, security, privacy, uptime, benchmarks and compliance** (for example "SOC 2 certified", "GDPR compliant", "bias-free", "unhackable") must be approved by Legal and supported by evidence. Overstating what our products or AI can do is "AI-washing" and can be deceptive.
- Customer testimonials, reviews and endorsements must be genuine, disclose any material connection (payment, free product, employment), and follow the FTC's Endorsement Guides. Never create or buy fake reviews.
- Email, text and telemarketing must follow CAN-SPAM, TCPA and state law, and Marketing must honor opt-outs promptly (within **10 business days** at most, and sooner where the law or platform requires).
- Use others' trademarks, logos and content only with permission or a legal right.

Bidding and competitive intelligence

- Gather competitive information only from public and legitimate sources: never through deception, hiring away a competitor's employee to get secrets, or accepting confidential information you suspect was improperly obtained.
- If you receive a competitor's or a customer's confidential information by mistake (for example, a leaked bid or a document from a former employer of a new hire), do not use or share it; tell Legal.

Responsibilities

- **Sales and Marketing leaders:** ensure claims are substantiated and approved; keep evidence files.
 - **Legal:** reviews non-standard terms and public claims; maintains approved-claims guidance.
 - **Everyone:** check first when unsure whether a claim is supported.
-

3.3 Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption

Purpose. To make sure Simtora never wins or keeps business, or an advantage, by corrupt means.

Scope. Everyone, and third parties who act for Simtora. This section applies to dealings with **government officials** and with **private-sector counterparties**, in the U.S. and abroad.

Laws we follow

Law	Coverage
Foreign Corrupt Practices Act (FCPA)	Prohibits offering, promising or giving anything of value, directly or through others, to a foreign official , political party, candidate or official of a public international organization to obtain or retain business or an improper advantage. Its accounting provisions require accurate books and adequate internal controls.
Domestic bribery and gratuity laws	Federal and state laws prohibit bribes and illegal gratuities to U.S. federal, state and local officials (for example, 18 U.S.C. § 201 and § 666).
Travel Act and commercial bribery laws	Prohibit bribes and kickbacks in private-sector dealings; state commercial bribery laws apply.
Anti-Kickback and procurement-integrity rules	Apply where Simtora sells to or through government or health programs.
Other countries' laws	UK Bribery Act and similar laws can apply to Simtora or its partners abroad and are stricter in some respects (for example, no exception for facilitation payments).

The rule

Simtora prohibits bribery in any form. No one may, directly or through another person, **offer, promise, give, authorize, request, agree to accept or accept** anything of value to or from any person, government official or private party, to:

- obtain or keep business, a contract or a license;
- influence an official act or decision, or a business decision; or
- secure any improper advantage or reward improper performance.

Anything of value

"Anything of value" is broader than cash. It includes gifts, meals, travel, entertainment, lodging, gift cards, loans, favors, jobs or internships for relatives, charitable or political

donations, sponsorships, consulting fees, discounts, free products or services, and use of assets. There is **no minimum amount**: a small gift can still be a bribe if it is meant to influence.

Government officials

The term includes elected and appointed officials at every level of government (federal, state, local, foreign); employees of government agencies, courts, legislatures and public schools or universities; employees of **state-owned or state-controlled** enterprises (which can include telecoms, banks, utilities and hospitals); officials of political parties and candidates; officials of public international organizations (like the UN or World Bank); and family members or representatives of any of these. If you are not sure whether someone is a government official, **treat them as one** and ask Compliance.

Facilitation ("grease") payments

Simtora **prohibits facilitation payments**, meaning small payments to speed up routine government actions. The narrow FCPA exception is not used at Simtora. The **only** exception is a payment made to protect a person from an immediate threat to their health or safety; it must be reported to Compliance within **24 hours** and recorded accurately.

Third parties and intermediaries

Simtora can be held responsible for what agents, resellers, consultants, distributors, lobbyists, customs and visa agents, and joint-venture partners do for us. Therefore:

- Engage third parties only after the risk-based due diligence in 6.5.
- Use written contracts with anti-corruption representations, audit rights and termination for breach.
- Pay only for services actually performed, at reasonable rates supported by records, to the named party, and to accounts in the party's own name and country of operation (no cash, third-country or personal accounts).
- Watch for and escalate **red flags**: commissions or fees higher than normal; requests for advance or cash payment; a party recommended by an official or with family or political ties; refusal to sign anti-corruption terms; vague services; a request to hide the party's role; a reputation for corruption; or requests that funds go to unrelated third parties.

Pre-approval requirements

Situation	Approval before acting
Any gift, meal, entertainment, travel or thing of value to a government official (any amount)	Compliance Officer in writing (General Counsel for foreign officials)
Hiring or contracting with a government official, or a relative of one, or a person referred by an official	Compliance Officer and General Counsel
Engaging an agent, reseller or consultant to deal with government or to obtain business in a high-risk country	Compliance Officer and General Counsel, after due diligence
Sponsorship, donation or grant connected to a customer or official	Compliance Officer (see 3.8)
Any payment to be made in cash, or to a third party or third country not connected to the transaction	CFO and Compliance Officer

Recording

Every payment, gift and expense involving a government official or third party must be recorded accurately and in reasonable detail in the books, with the true purpose.

Concealing a purpose is a separate violation.

Reporting

Report any request for a bribe, kickback or improper payment (even if you refused) to Compliance within **1 business day** and do not proceed with the transaction until Compliance responds. If refusing would put a person in danger, protect yourself first and then report.

Consequences

Bribery is gross misconduct and may result in termination, and in personal criminal liability (fines and imprisonment) and severe penalties for the Company.

3.4 Gifts, Meals, Entertainment and Hospitality

Purpose. To allow ordinary business courtesy while preventing anything that could influence, or seem to influence, a business decision.

Scope. Anything of value that an employee (or a family member on their behalf) gives or receives in connection with Simtora business. Gifts to a family member or friend are treated as gifts to the employee. This section applies to private-sector counterparties; for government officials, see 3.3 and the table below.

General rules

A gift, meal or entertainment may be given or accepted only if it:

1. Is **modest and customary** for the business setting;
2. Has a **legitimate business purpose** (building relationships, explaining products), is **not lavish**, and is not frequent;
3. Is **not given or accepted to influence** a decision or reward one, and would not embarrass Simtora if made public;
4. Is **not solicited**;
5. **Never cash or cash equivalents** (gift cards, vouchers, securities, cryptocurrency, loans);
6. Is **lawful** under local law and the recipient's employer's rules (many organizations, including governments and some corporations, ban gifts); and
7. Is **accurately recorded** in the expense system or the gift log.

Thresholds

Type	No approval	Prior approval	Not allowed
Gifts (per source or recipient per calendar year, total value)	Up to \$50	50.01to250: Department Head, logged in the gift register. Over 250 : * * <i>DepartmentHead</i> * *and * * <i>ComplianceOfficer</i> .Over * *1,000: General Counsel as well.	Cash and equivalents; anything solicited; anything during an active tender or negotiation (see below)
Business meals (per person, per occasion)	Up to \$100, infrequent (not more than 4 occasions per source per year), with a business discussion and the host present	Above the limits: Department Head and Compliance Officer	Lavish or recurring meals; venues that would embarrass the Company

Per-source limits are aggregated across the year, so several small gifts from one source count together. Where local law or the counterparty's policy is stricter, follow the stricter limit.

Special situations

- **Active tender, bid, RFP or negotiation.** No gifts, meals or entertainment may be offered to or accepted from a party that is in an active procurement, tender, vendor evaluation, contract negotiation or renewal with Simtora, until the decision is made and documented. Employees involved in selection must decline any gift.
- **Declining gifts.** If a gift is above the limit, politely decline and return it with a note explaining the policy. If returning it would cause real offense or is impractical, accept on behalf of the Company, tell Compliance within **5 business days**, and the gift will be shared, raffled, donated or displayed.
- **Perishable gifts** (a fruit basket, food for the team) may be accepted and shared with the team.
- **Conferences and speaking honoraria.** Free conference passes and speaking fees from vendors or customers need Department Head approval. A speaker's honorarium goes to Simtora unless Compliance approves otherwise.
- **Vendor-paid events, training and demos.** Accept only when there is a clear business purpose, and the value is reasonable and disclosed to your manager.
- **Customers and prospective customers.** The same thresholds apply to gifts and hospitality we give. Marketing events and customer appreciation programs are budgeted and approved in advance by the Department Head and reviewed by Compliance.
- **Rewards and referral programs.** Referral fees, finders' fees and channel incentives are business arrangements that require a written contract approved by Legal (never a personal gift).
- **Charitable gifts in someone's honor.** Treated as gifts in kind.

Recording and review

- Gifts and hospitality above the "no approval" thresholds are requested and recorded using Appendix C and kept in the **gift register**, maintained by Compliance.
- Compliance reviews the register **quarterly** for patterns (frequency, same source, high-risk roles) and reports to the Compliance Committee.

- Expense claims for gifts and hospitality must name the recipient, their organization and the business purpose (see HR 1.6 and the Finance and Accounting Manual, SIM-FIN-001, 4.10).
-

3.5 Conflicts of Interest

Purpose. To ensure that decisions made for Simtora are made for Simtora, not for personal benefit or that of family or friends.

Scope. Everyone. Those with authority to buy or sell, to influence a purchase or price, to hire, or with access to confidential information must be especially careful.

What is a conflict of interest

A conflict exists when a personal, financial, family or other outside interest **could influence, or reasonably appear to influence**, your judgment or your duty to Simtora. Having a conflict is not a violation. **Failing to disclose it is.** An apparent conflict is treated like an actual one.

Common conflicts

Category	Examples	Rule
Financial interests	You or a close family member owns or has an interest in a competitor, customer, vendor, distributor or partner; is a creditor or debtor; or receives payments from one	Disclose any interest in a private company that does business with or competes with Simtora. Ownership of less than 1% of a public company, or through diversified mutual funds, is not a conflict unless you can influence the deal.
Family and personal relationships	A relative or partner works for, or runs, a vendor, customer or competitor; you would hire, supervise or influence pay or promotion of a relative or partner	Disclose. You must recuse yourself from any decision about them. For relationships within the Company see HR 5.5.
Outside work and side businesses	Second job, consulting, freelance, advisory board, or a startup that overlaps or competes, or that uses Company time, resources or information	Approval required as in HR 1.8. Engineering, security and product roles need written approval for paid technology work.
Board and advisory roles	Directorship or advisory role with a for-profit entity	Approval from the Department Head and the General Counsel before accepting. Non-profit boards need disclosure (approval only if they involve Simtora customers, vendors or funding).

The list is not complete. **If in doubt, disclose.**

How to disclose

1. **Disclose in writing** using Appendix B or the conflicts portal, to your **manager and Compliance, before** engaging in the activity, or as soon as you learn of the conflict.
2. Compliance, with your manager and HR where relevant, decides within **10 business days** how to manage it and records the outcome in the **conflicts register**.
3. Typical management steps: no action (with record); recusal from specific decisions; separation of reporting lines; restricted access to information; divestment; limits on the outside activity; or, in rare cases, requiring you to end the activity or the interest.
4. You must **update** the disclosure if circumstances change, and reconfirm annually (see 6.3).
5. Failure to disclose, or acting contrary to the management plan, is a violation.

Who decides

Person with the conflict	Decision-maker
Employee	Manager and Compliance Officer (HR for employment-related relationships)
Department Head or Executive Team member (other than the CEO)	General Counsel with the CEO; reported to the Audit Committee
CEO, General Counsel, CFO, Compliance Officer or a director	Audit Committee

Related-party transactions

Any transaction or arrangement above **\$10,000** in a year between Simtora and a director, an Executive Team member, their family members, or an entity in which any of them has a material interest requires prior review by the Audit Committee. Compliance keeps a list of such parties and Finance checks payments against it (see the Finance and Accounting Manual, SIM-FIN-001, 1.2).

Vendor selection and sourcing

A person with a conflict about a vendor must not take part in selecting, evaluating, negotiating with, approving or paying that vendor. Procurement staff must complete a conflict declaration for each tender (see the Procurement Policy Manual, 2.1).

3.6 Fair Competition and Antitrust

Purpose. To ensure Simtora competes vigorously and lawfully, and complies with federal and state antitrust and competition laws (including the Sherman Act, Clayton Act, Robinson-Patman Act and the FTC Act) and equivalent foreign laws.

Scope. Everyone, and especially those in Sales, Marketing, Product, Partnerships, Procurement, HR and Executives, and anyone who attends trade associations or industry events.

Why it matters

Antitrust violations can be **crimes**. Price fixing, bid rigging and market allocation can lead to prison for individuals and very large fines for the Company, plus private suits for treble damages. An informal or "gentlemen's" understanding, a text message, or a wink can be enough.

Never agree with a competitor to:

- fix, raise, lower, stabilize or coordinate **prices**, discounts, fees, rebates, terms or price changes;
- **rig bids**: agree who will win, submit courtesy or complementary bids, or withhold a bid;
- **allocate** customers, territories, products or markets;
- limit output, capacity or the features or quality of products;
- **boycott** or refuse to deal with a customer, supplier or another competitor;
- **fix wages or benefits**, or agree not to **hire or solicit** each other's employees (no-poach), or share non-public compensation data with competitors. The Department of Justice and FTC treat naked wage-fixing and no-poach agreements as **criminal** conduct. This includes informal agreements with partner or customer companies unless narrowly tailored to a legitimate collaboration approved by Legal in advance.

Sharing information with competitors

Do not exchange non-public **competitively sensitive information** with competitors, whether directly, through a third party or in a group. This includes pricing, costs, margins, discounts, bids, customer lists and contracts, product roadmaps, capacity, strategic plans, and compensation, hiring and salary plans. When a competitor is also a customer, partner, supplier or reseller, limit contact to what the legitimate relationship needs.

Practical rules

Situation	What to do
A competitor raises pricing, bids, customers or hiring	Stop the conversation immediately. State clearly that you will not discuss it. Leave the meeting if necessary. Report it to Legal the same day. Silence can be treated as agreement.
Trade associations, standards bodies, conferences	Attend only with an agenda; leave if sensitive topics arise; ensure minutes reflect your objection. Register memberships with Compliance. Do not join a group whose purpose is unclear.
Benchmarking and surveys	Use third-party aggregators, with data that is historical, anonymized and aggregated; Legal must approve before Simtora shares or gets competitor data.
Customers and resellers	Do not set the resale price a partner charges (minimum or fixed resale prices can be unlawful). Suggested prices and maximum prices are permitted with Legal's advice.
Exclusive dealing, tying, bundling and loyalty discounts	May be unlawful depending on market power and effect; get Legal approval for exclusivity clauses, requirements that a customer buy one product to get another, or unusual discounts.
Below-cost pricing, discrimination between similar customers	Get Legal advice before adopting.
Mergers, acquisitions, joint ventures and partnerships	Legal reviews for antitrust and premerger filing (HSR) requirements; no information sharing or joint conduct before closing ("gun-jumping").
Communications	Write carefully and factually. Avoid loose statements like "dominate," "crush," "lock out" or "we agreed with [competitor]."

Responsibilities

- **Legal** provides antitrust training to at-risk roles annually (see 6.2) and reviews high-risk contracts and programs.
 - **Managers** in sales, partnerships and HR must not allow contacts that create risk.
 - **HR** must not exchange salary data with other companies outside legitimate, Legal-approved surveys.
-

3.7 Anti-Money Laundering, Sanctions and Export Controls

Purpose. To keep Simtora from being used to move illicit funds, and to comply with economic sanctions, export controls and anti-boycott rules that restrict who we can do business with and what we can send where.

Scope. Everyone, and especially Sales, Finance, Product, Engineering, Support, Procurement and Legal. These rules apply to software, cloud services, technical data, source code, encryption, support and payments, **wherever the person receiving them is located.**

Anti-money laundering (AML)

Money laundering is the process of disguising the source of illegally obtained funds. Simtora complies with the Bank Secrecy Act and similar laws as they apply and does not accept or make payments that we suspect involve proceeds of crime.

- Accept payment only **from the customer named in the contract**, by ordinary methods (wire, ACH, card), in the contract currency, and from an account in the customer's name and normal country of operation.
- **Red flags** (report to Finance and Compliance): payments from unrelated third parties; overpayment followed by a refund request; payment in cash or virtual currency; requests to send refunds to a different account or country; reluctance to give information about ownership; transactions with no clear business purpose; splitting payments to avoid thresholds; unusually complex structures.
- Cash payments over ****1, 000 ***
**are not accepted. Finance files any required reports (for example, IRS Form 8300 f*

10,000).

- Finance and Compliance decide on any suspicious transaction and any required government report. **Never tip off** the party about an internal report or inquiry.

Economic sanctions

The Office of Foreign Assets Control (OFAC) and other authorities restrict dealings with certain countries, regions, governments, entities and individuals.

- Simtora does **not** do business, directly or indirectly, with **comprehensively sanctioned jurisdictions** (currently including Cuba, Iran, North Korea, Syria, and the Crimea, Donetsk and Luhansk regions of Ukraine), or with persons on the **Specially Designated Nationals (SDN) list** and other restricted-party lists, or with entities they own or control (50 percent or more). Legal maintains and publishes the current list; the intranet copy governs.
- Sanctions apply to our **customers, users, resellers, vendors, investors and employees**. They also restrict **services**, including software licenses, cloud access, support, payments and updates.
- **Screening**. Legal and Sales Operations screen new customers, resellers, vendors and significant users against restricted-party lists **before** contract signature and periodically after (at least **annually** and on any list update for high-risk parties). Engineering and IT block access from embargoed jurisdictions (see IT 8.3). Procurement screens vendors (see the Procurement Policy Manual, 4.2).
- **Stop and ask** if a customer, user, payment or shipment has any link to a sanctioned country or person, including by IP address, billing address, language or a request to route through another country.
- **Ransom and extortion payments** require Legal advice on sanctions risk before any decision (see IT 7.4 and the Approval Matrix).

Export controls

The Export Administration Regulations (EAR), administered by the Department of Commerce, control exports and re-exports of software, technology and encryption, and access by foreign persons ("**deemed exports**"). Some products may be subject to the International Traffic in Arms Regulations (ITAR).

- Legal **classifies** each Simtora product (for example, under an Export Control Classification Number (ECCN), including for encryption under Category 5 Part 2) and maintains a classification record. **Product and Engineering must involve Legal before adding new encryption, security, AI model, or defense-related capability, or open-sourcing code.**
- Do not send, upload, give access to, or discuss source code, technical data or controlled technology with a foreign person or in another country until Legal confirms it is permitted. This includes hiring, contractors, interns and visitors, and remote access.
- **Travel.** Do not take Company devices or data to sanctioned or high-risk countries, and do not work from any country other than your country of employment without approval (see IT 4.6, HR 5.2 and SIM-HR-002, Part 1.9).
- **End-use and end-user.** Watch for signs that products will be used for prohibited purposes such as weapons, military, or surveillance uses, or be diverted to a restricted party. Report concerns to Legal.
- **Recordkeeping.** Export and sanctions records are kept for at least **5 years** (longer under a hold).

Anti-boycott

U.S. law prohibits taking part in unsanctioned foreign boycotts (such as the Arab League boycott of Israel) and requires reporting some boycott requests. Do not agree to boycott-related terms in a contract, questionnaire or letter of credit. **Send any such request to Legal immediately.** Legal makes required reports.

Customs and import

When Simtora imports hardware, Procurement or Facilities must use licensed customs brokers, declare accurate values and origin, and comply with forced labor import bans (see 5.2). Do not undervalue or mislabel goods.

Responsibilities

- **General Counsel:** owns the trade-compliance program, screening rules, classification and government filings.
- **Sales Operations and Finance:** run screening and payment controls.

- **Engineering and IT:** implement blocking and access controls; do not release controlled technology without clearance.
 - **Everyone:** ask Legal before dealing with anything that has an unusual country, party or end use.
-

3.8 Political Activity, Lobbying and Charitable Giving

Purpose. To respect employees' civic freedom while keeping Company resources out of politics and ensuring charitable giving is genuine.

Personal political activity

- Employees are free to take part in political and civic life on their own time, with their own resources. Simtora will **not** reward or penalize anyone for a lawful political view, vote or contribution (subject to state law that protects such activity).
- Make clear you speak for yourself, not for Simtora. Do not use your Simtora title, email address, letterhead, devices, or time for political activity.
- Simtora will **not reimburse** any personal political contribution, directly or indirectly (for example through bonuses, expense claims or "reimbursed" donations), and does not pressure anyone to contribute or to support a candidate or cause.
- Employees who run for or hold public office must tell their manager and Compliance beforehand so that conflicts and time commitments can be managed.

Company political activity

- Simtora does **not** make contributions to federal, state or local candidates, parties, political committees (including super PACs) or ballot-measure campaigns, and does not operate a corporate PAC, unless the **CEO and General Counsel** approve in writing and the **Board** is informed in advance. Use of Company funds, facilities, equipment or employee work time for political purposes is otherwise prohibited.
- **Industry associations.** Membership in trade associations that engage in lobbying is approved by the Department Head and registered with Compliance, which reviews the associations' policy activities annually.
- **Pay-to-play.** Federal, state and local rules restrict contributions by companies (and sometimes by executives and employees) that seek or hold government contracts.

Employees in government sales must tell Compliance before making political contributions to officials or candidates who could influence a government purchase, and before Simtora bids in a jurisdiction with such rules.

Lobbying

- Contact with government officials to influence legislation, regulation or procurement decisions ("lobbying") is subject to registration and disclosure laws at the federal, state and local levels, which apply even to some employees who spend a small portion of their time on it.
- **Only Legal-approved** employees or registered lobbyists may lobby for Simtora. Anyone contacted by, or planning to contact, a legislator, regulator or staff member about legislation, rules or public policy on Simtora's behalf must **tell Legal first**.
- Engagement of outside lobbyists requires General Counsel approval and due diligence (see 6.5).
- Compliance tracks lobbying activity and Legal makes the required filings.

Charitable donations and sponsorships

- Simtora encourages community giving, and the annual charitable budget is set by the CEO with the CFO. Donations are made only to bona fide charitable organizations, **never in exchange for, or to influence, a business or government decision**.
 - Approvals: up to 5,000 * *per organization per year* : *Department Head with a Compliance check*; * *above 5,000*: CEO and General Counsel. **Any donation** connected in any way to a customer, prospect, government official or their designated charity requires **Compliance Officer** approval first.
 - Due diligence: confirm the recipient's tax-exempt status and reputation and that funds go to the organization's account, not a person; keep a written record of purpose and approval.
 - Sponsorships and event sponsorships that give Simtora marketing benefits are business expenses, approved under the Finance and Accounting Manual (SIM-FIN-001, 4.10) and reviewed by Compliance if any official or customer is involved.
 - Do not use donations to obtain permits, avoid inspection or win an award.
-

3.9 Working with Government Customers

Purpose. To ensure that any sales to or through federal, state, local or foreign governments comply with the special rules that apply to government business. Selling to government is subject to laws that do not apply to commercial deals, and violations can lead to fines, debarment and criminal charges.

Scope. Anyone who sells to, supports, contracts with, or manages work for a government customer, or a prime contractor or reseller serving government. Compliance and Legal must be consulted **before** Simtora bids on any government contract or joins a government-facing program.

Before bidding

- **Legal and Compliance approve** every government bid and teaming agreement, after review of the solicitation, applicable clauses (Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR), agency supplements, state rules), pricing rules, security requirements (for example FedRAMP, FISMA/NIST SP 800-171, CMMC, StateRAMP), and small-business or origin requirements.
- Determine whether Simtora will be subject to special obligations (cost or pricing data, audits, mandatory disclosure, flow-down clauses).

Core rules

Rule	What it means
Truthful and complete information	All proposals, certifications, invoices and reports to government must be accurate and complete. False statements or claims can violate the False Claims Act , the Truth in Negotiations Act, and criminal statutes, with treble damages and per-claim penalties. Deliver what we certify.
Procurement integrity	Never seek or accept non-public procurement information (competitors' bids or proposals, source-selection information) or discuss future employment with a procurement official during a live procurement. Report any receipt of such information to Legal at once.
Gifts and gratuities	No gifts (including meals and coffee) to federal, state and local government personnel without Compliance's prior written approval; most jurisdictions ban them or set very low limits (see 3.3, 3.4).
Revolving door and hiring	Rules limit hiring former government employees and contact with them on matters they handled. Check with Compliance and HR before recruiting or engaging a current or former government employee.
Accurate costs and timekeeping	Time and costs charged to government contracts must be recorded accurately and promptly, on the correct project. Mischarging is a serious violation.
Cybersecurity and data	Meet contract security requirements (FISMA/NIST, FedRAMP, CMMC, incident-reporting clocks that can be as short as 72 hours , often shorter) and protect Controlled Unclassified Information. Coordinate with IT Security (see IT 1.4, 7.4, 9.3).
Supply chain restrictions	Comply with restrictions on covered telecom and video-surveillance equipment (Section 889), prohibited software or vendors, and country-of-origin rules (Trade Agreements Act). Procurement checks components and vendors.
Subcontracting and teaming	

Mandatory disclosure (federal contractors)

If Simtora holds or bids on federal contracts, the FAR requires **timely written disclosure** to the agency Inspector General and Contracting Officer when there is **credible evidence** of a violation of federal criminal law involving fraud, conflict of interest, bribery or gratuity violations, or of a False Claims Act violation, in connection with a federal contract. Failure to disclose is itself grounds for suspension or debarment. **Anyone who learns of such a possibility must report it to the General Counsel immediately.** The General Counsel decides on disclosure, informs the Audit Committee and documents the decision.

State and local government and education

State and local government and public school and university customers have their own procurement, gift, ethics, lobbying, contribution and open-records laws. **Treat every public-sector customer as a government official** for the purposes of 3.3 and 3.4, and get Legal's guidance before offering anything.

Responsibilities

- **General Counsel:** approves government bids and contracts; owns the government contracts compliance program; makes disclosures.
- **Sales and delivery leaders:** follow the rules; keep records; report concerns.
- **Finance:** accurate billing, cost accounting and audits.
- **IT Security:** contractual security controls and incident reporting.

3.10 Insider Trading and Securities

Purpose. To prevent misuse of inside information and to comply with securities laws.

Scope. Everyone with access to non-public information about Simtora or any other company learned through their work. Simtora's own securities are not publicly traded at the effective date of this manual. **If Simtora ever registers securities or lists on an exchange, the Compliance Officer will adopt a full insider trading policy with trading windows and pre-clearance, and this section will apply to Simtora securities as well.**

The rule

It is illegal, and against this manual, to **buy or sell** the securities (stocks, bonds, options, derivatives, or similar interests) of any company while aware of **material non-public information (MNPI)** about that company, or to **tip** others, including family and friends, who then trade. This applies to customers, vendors, partners, competitors, acquisition targets and investors, whose confidential information we may receive because of our work.

What is MNPI

Information is **material** if a reasonable investor would consider it important in deciding whether to buy, sell or hold, and **non-public** until it has been broadly disclosed and the market has had time to absorb it. Examples: unannounced financial results, earnings or forecasts; a major contract win or loss; mergers, acquisitions, divestitures, investments; new products or major delays; **data breaches or serious security incidents**; litigation or regulatory action; leadership changes; financing; restructuring.

Because Simtora provides technology to many companies (some public), employees may see MNPI about them (for example, usage volumes, planned launches, incidents, contract terms). **Treat all customer and partner information as confidential and possible MNPI.**

What you must do

- Do **not** trade in the securities of a company (or any related company) while you have MNPI about it, and do not recommend or tip others to trade.
- Do **not** use MNPI to hedge, short-sell or trade options on a company's stock.
- Ask Legal **before** trading in the securities of a **customer, partner or acquisition target** that you work with closely, if you have any doubt about what you know.
- Keep MNPI secure: share only with those who have a genuine need to know, and follow the data-handling rules in IT 2.1 and Appendix E of the IT manual.
- Violations can lead to criminal penalties, civil penalties and personal liability, and are grounds for termination.

Pre-IPO and private equity interests

Investments in customers' or vendors' private offerings, shares acquired through a customer or vendor, or "friends and family" allocations must be disclosed under 3.5 and

may be refused.

Part 4 – Data, Privacy and Responsible Technology

4.1 Privacy Program

Purpose. To make sure Simtora respects the privacy of customers, users, employees, candidates and partners, and complies with privacy laws. Technical controls and day-to-day handling rules are in the IT Policy Manual (2.1 and 2.5); this section sets the governance, rights and decision-making.

Scope. All personal information Simtora collects, uses, stores or shares, whether as a business (controller) or as a service provider or processor for customers.

Laws that apply

Area	Examples
State comprehensive privacy laws	California CCPA/CPRA and the many other state laws (for example Virginia, Colorado, Connecticut, Texas and more)
Sensitive and special data	Biometrics (Illinois BIPA, Texas, Washington), health data (HIPAA where we are a business associate; Washington My Health My Data Act), children's data (COPPA, state age-appropriate design laws), precise geolocation, financial data (GLBA where flowed down)
Employment data	State employee-privacy, background-check (FCRA and state "ban-the-box") and monitoring-notice laws (see HR 1.9 and IT 4.8)
Marketing and tracking	

Legal maintains the details in the Legal Requirements Register (6.1).

Principles

1. **Transparency.** Tell people clearly what we collect and why. Privacy notices are accurate and reviewed by Legal.
2. **Purpose and minimization.** Collect only what is needed, use it only for the stated purposes, and keep it no longer than needed.
3. **Choice and rights.** Honor opt-outs, and access, correction, deletion, portability and other rights the law gives.
4. **Security.** Protect data with controls that match its classification (IT 2.1, Part 5).
5. **Accountability.** Document what we do, assess risk, and be able to show it.
6. **No surprises.** Do not use personal data for a new purpose (including training AI models) without a legal review and, where required, notice or consent.

Roles

Role	Responsibilities
General Counsel	Owns the privacy program; designates the Privacy Lead (in Legal); decides on breach notification; approves privacy notices and data-protection terms.
Privacy Lead	Runs assessments, requests, vendor reviews, the data map and training; advises Product and Engineering.
Head of IT / CISO	Security controls, data map inputs, incident response, deletion tooling.
Product and Engineering leaders	Complete privacy review before launching features that use personal data; build in privacy by design.
Data owners	Accountable for a data set: classification, access and retention decisions.
HR	Employee and candidate data; notices and consents for HR data.
All employees	Handle personal data only as needed for their job; report suspected misuse or loss right away.

Requirements

- **Data map and records.** Legal and IT keep a current record of what personal data is collected, where it is stored, why, who it is shared with, and the retention period. Reviewed at least **annually** and when systems change.
- **Privacy by design and impact assessments.** A **privacy review** is required before launch of any new product, feature, data source, tracking technology, AI use, or vendor that involves personal data, and a documented **privacy impact assessment** for high-risk processing (sensitive data, children, large-scale profiling, automated decisions with significant effects, biometrics, precise location).
- **Individual requests.** Requests (access, deletion, correction, opt-out of sale/sharing and targeted advertising, limits on sensitive data use, appeals) are handled through the published request channel. Requests are **acknowledged within 10 business days**, and completed **within 45 days** (with one extension of up to 45 more days where the law

permits and the person is told why). Requesters' identity is verified. Anyone who receives a request forwards it to the Privacy Lead **the same business day**. Simtora does not discriminate against people who use their rights.

- **Customer data.** Where Simtora processes personal data for customers, it does so only on the customer's documented instructions under a data processing agreement, keeps it separate, and returns or deletes it as the contract requires (within **30 days** after contract end, per IT 2.5).
- **Vendors and sharing.** Personal data is shared only with vendors that have passed the review in IT 8.1 and signed a data protection addendum. Simtora does not sell personal information. Sharing for cross-context advertising requires Legal approval, notice and opt-out mechanisms.
- **International transfers.** Transfers of EU or UK personal data use approved mechanisms (such as Data Privacy Framework certification or standard contractual clauses) recorded by Legal.
- **Employee and candidate data.** Collected and used only for legitimate HR purposes; access limited to those who need it; background checks and monitoring follow HR 1.1, HR 1.9 and IT 4.8.
- **Children.** Simtora does not knowingly collect data from children under 13 (or older where the law says) except where a product is designed for it with COPPA-compliant controls approved by Legal.
- **Training.** Everyone completes privacy training within **30 days of hire** and annually (see 6.2), with additional training for roles with heavy data access.

Privacy incidents and breach decisions

- Any suspected unauthorized access to, or loss of, personal information is a **security incident** and must be reported through IT 7.4 (within **1 hour** for lost or stolen devices, and immediately for anything else).
- The **General Counsel** makes the decision whether, when and how to notify individuals, regulators, customers, credit bureaus, insurers and law enforcement, with the CISO and (for SEV 1) the CEO. State deadlines vary (some are as short as 30 days), GDPR requires notice to the authority within **72 hours**, and customer contracts commonly require notice within **72 hours** or sooner. Legal tracks each clock from the moment of awareness.

- Legal keeps a **breach decision record** for every incident, including where notification is not required, and reports to the Audit Committee (see 6.9).
-

4.2 Confidential Information, Trade Secrets and Third-Party Intellectual Property

Purpose. To protect Simtora's, customers' and third parties' information and intellectual property (IP).

Scope. Everyone. The HR manual (1.8) sets the employee agreement, invention assignment and protected-rights language; the IT manual sets technical handling. This section sets the compliance standards.

Protecting confidential information

- **Simtora confidential information** includes source code, architecture, product plans, security details, pricing, financials, customer lists and personnel data. Handle it by its data classification (IT 2.1); share it only on a need-to-know basis and, outside the Company, only under a signed **non-disclosure agreement (NDA)** approved by Legal or on Legal's template.
- **Customer and partner confidential information** is protected under our contracts and equal to our own. Use it only for the purpose it was shared for.
- **Do not discuss** confidential matters in public places, on social media or with the press. Do not send Company information to personal email, personal cloud storage or unapproved tools, including unapproved AI tools (IT 4.5).
- **Departing employees** must return all Company information and property. Confidentiality continues after employment (subject to the protected rights in 2.5).

Respecting third-party IP

- Do not copy, use or distribute copyrighted software, code, images, fonts, music, data or documents without a **license or other right**. Track licenses through IT 2.3 and Procurement.
- **Open source.** Use of open-source code follows the licensing and review process in IT 6.3, including compliance with license obligations (attribution, copyleft, notices) and

software bill of materials (SBOM) practices. Contributing Company code to open-source projects requires the approvals in HR 1.8 and IT 6.3.

- **Former employers and others.** Do not bring, disclose, or use confidential information, trade secrets, source code or documents belonging to a former employer or any third party. New hires sign an acknowledgement of this at onboarding and are reminded that they may not use such information in their work.
- **Inbound claims.** If anyone alleges Simtora is infringing their IP or misusing their confidential information, or sends a takedown or demand letter, **forward it to Legal the same day** and do not respond yourself.
- **Trademarks and brand.** Use Simtora and third-party marks only per the brand guidelines and with permission.
- **DMCA and user content.** Where Simtora hosts user content, Legal maintains a designated agent and a takedown process under the Digital Millennium Copyright Act.
- **Generative AI and IP.** Do not put third-party confidential or copyrighted material into AI tools unless the tool's terms and the material's license allow it (see 4.3).

Simtora's IP

- Work product created in the scope of employment belongs to Simtora as described in HR 1.8 (with the legal carve-outs described there).
- Legal manages patents, trademarks, copyrights and trade-secret programs, including invention disclosure. Employees must disclose inventions promptly (HR 1.8).
- Publications, conference papers and public talks that describe Simtora technology need review by the Department Head and Legal at least **10 business days** before submission.

4.3 Responsible AI and Ethical Technology

Purpose. To make sure that Simtora builds, buys and uses AI and other powerful technology in ways that are lawful, fair, safe, secure and accountable. The IT manual sets the technical rules for the Approved AI Tools list and handling of data in AI tools (IT 4.5); this section sets the ethical and legal governance.

Scope. AI and machine learning features Simtora builds or sells, AI tools employees use in their work, and any automated decision-making that affects people.

Principles

Principle	What it requires
Lawful and compliant	Meet laws on privacy, anti-discrimination, consumer protection, IP, export controls and AI-specific rules (for example, Colorado's AI Act, state and city automated-decision and hiring laws, the EU AI Act where we serve the EU, and FTC guidance).
Fair	Test for and reduce unlawful or unjustified bias, especially where AI affects employment, credit, housing, insurance, health, education or access to services.
Transparent	Tell people when they are interacting with AI or when AI has a significant role in a decision about them, and explain in plain language what the system does and its limits.
Human accountability	A named person is accountable for each AI system. High-impact decisions have meaningful human review . AI does not make final decisions about hiring, firing, discipline or pay without human review.
Safe and secure	Testing, red-teaming and monitoring for harmful, unsafe or manipulable behavior; protection against prompt injection and data leakage (IT 6.1 and 4.5).
Privacy-respecting	Use personal data in AI only with a legal basis, minimizing it; do not train models on customer data unless the contract and law allow it and Legal has approved.
Honest	No exaggerated or false claims about AI capabilities (see 3.2). Do not present AI output as human work where that would mislead.
Respect for creators	Respect IP in training data and outputs, and follow licenses and opt-outs.

Governance

- **AI Review Board** (a working group of Legal/Privacy, IT Security, Product, Engineering, HR and Compliance, chaired by the General Counsel or a designee) reviews **high-risk AI uses** and reports to the Compliance Committee **quarterly**.
- **Risk tiers.**

Tier	Examples	Requirements
Low	Drafting help, code assistance with approved tools, internal summarization with no sensitive data	Approved AI tool (IT 4.5); user responsibility for checking output
Medium	Customer-facing AI features, analytics on personal data, recommendation features	Privacy review; testing for accuracy and bias; documentation ("model card" or equivalent); named owner; monitoring
High	AI used in decisions about people (employment, credit, housing, health, education, legal rights, benefits), biometrics, safety-critical use, autonomous agents with write access to production or customer systems	All of the above, plus an AI impact assessment approved by the AI Review Board, human oversight design, user notices and appeals where required, and pre-launch approval by the General Counsel and CISO
Prohibited	Social scoring; emotion recognition in the workplace or schools (except for medical or safety reasons); manipulative or deceptive techniques causing harm; biometric categorization of protected traits; untargeted scraping of facial images; use that violates law or sanctions	Not permitted

- **Employee use of AI tools.** Use only tools on the **Approved AI Tools list** (approved by IT Security and Legal); follow the data-handling matrix in IT Appendix E (no Restricted data unless the CISO and General Counsel approve); review and verify all AI output

before relying on it; do not present it as your own where disclosure is required; and never use AI to create deceptive, discriminatory, harassing or infringing content. You remain responsible for the work you produce.

- **Hiring and HR.** Any AI or automated tool used to screen, rank, evaluate or monitor candidates or employees must be reviewed by HR, Legal and Compliance before use, tested for adverse impact, and comply with applicable notice and audit laws (for example, New York City's automated employment decision tool law, Illinois and Colorado rules).
- **Incidents.** Harmful, biased, unsafe or unexpected AI behavior, or a data leak through an AI tool, is reported as a security or compliance incident (IT 7.4; 2.1 here).
- **Documentation and records.** Keep records of risk tier, testing, assessments, owner and decisions for each AI system for at least **7 years** after retirement.

Wider ethical technology

- Before building or selling a capability that could be used for **surveillance, deception, or harm to individuals or groups**, Product and Engineering leaders must consult Legal and Compliance. Simtora will not knowingly supply technology for unlawful surveillance, human-rights abuses, or illegal discrimination.
- Employees may raise a concern about the ethics of a product or project through any channel in 2.1, without retaliation. Ethical concerns about a product are logged and reviewed by the Compliance Committee.

4.4 Records Management and Legal Holds

Purpose. To keep the records we need, delete those we do not, and never lose evidence needed in a legal matter.

Scope. All records in any form: paper, email, chat, documents, source code repositories, tickets, recordings, databases and logs, on Company systems and on personal devices or accounts if used for work.

Retention schedule

The **General Counsel** owns the Company **Records Retention Schedule**, published on the intranet and reviewed annually. The IT manual sets technical retention (IT 2.5). Minimum periods, unless law or contract requires longer:

Record	Minimum retention
Corporate records (charter, bylaws, Board and committee minutes and resolutions, stock records)	Permanent
Financial statements, general ledger, tax returns and workpapers, audit reports	7 years (permanent for annual statements)
Accounts payable and receivable, expense records, bank records	7 years
Contracts and related correspondence	7 years after expiry or termination
Payroll and personnel records	7 years after separation (HR 9.4); Form I-9 the later of 3 years from hire or 1 year after separation; medical and exposure records as OSHA requires
Recruiting records (applicants not hired)	3 years (longer where state law requires)
Government contract records	Per contract and FAR (generally at least 3 years after final payment; 7 years by default at Simtora)
Trade, export and sanctions records	5 years
Ethics Line and investigation files	7 years after closure
Compliance training records, certifications, registers (gifts, conflicts)	7 years
Insurance policies and claims	Permanent for policies; 7 years for claims after closure

Rules

- **Keep what is needed, delete what is not.** Records past their retention period are deleted securely (IT 2.4) unless on legal hold. Do not keep personal or duplicate copies "just in case."
- **Store records in approved systems,** not personal devices, accounts or ephemeral messaging. Business communications on tools with auto-delete must comply with the retention schedule.
- **Never destroy, alter, conceal or falsify** any record to obstruct or influence an investigation, audit, inquiry or proceeding, or in contemplation of one. This is a federal crime (for example, 18 U.S.C. § 1519) with up to 20 years' imprisonment.

Legal holds

A **legal hold** suspends deletion of records that may be relevant to actual or reasonably anticipated litigation, an investigation, an audit or a government inquiry.

Step	Detail	Owner	Timing
1. Trigger	A lawsuit, demand letter, subpoena, regulator contact, internal investigation, or credible threat of any of these. Anyone who learns of one must tell Legal at once.	Anyone	Immediately
2. Issue the hold	Written notice identifying custodians, subjects, systems and date range; tells recipients not to delete or alter	General Counsel	Within 2 business days of the trigger
3. Preserve	IT suspends automated deletion (email, chat, cloud drives, backups, logs, devices, repositories) and images devices as needed	IT	Within 1 business day of the hold notice (IT 2.5)
4. Acknowledge			

Legal keeps a register of active holds. Failing to follow a hold is serious misconduct that can lead to court sanctions against the Company and to personal liability.

4.5 Public Statements, Media and Social Media

Purpose. To make sure the Company speaks with one accurate voice, while protecting employees' right to speak for themselves and about their working conditions.

Scope. Everyone. This applies to media, conferences, podcasts, blogs, customer references, and social media, whether posting officially or personally.

Speaking for Simtora

- Only **authorized spokespeople** speak for Simtora: the CEO, Communications, and people they designate in writing. Refer all media, analyst, investor and regulator inquiries to **Communications** (and Legal for legal or regulatory topics) without comment.
- Before a public talk, publication, customer reference or case study that names Simtora, get approval as set out in 4.2 and from Communications. Customer names, logos and quotes may be used only with the customer's written permission.
- **Crisis communications.** Statements about incidents, breaches, litigation or investigations are approved by the General Counsel and CEO (see IT 7.4).

Official social media accounts

- Only designated colleagues post on official accounts. They must be professional and accurate, respect IP and confidentiality, comply with advertising rules (see 3.2) and follow Communications' guidelines.
- Do not post or disclose MNPI, confidential or customer information, information under NDA, or unreleased product plans.
- Do not comment on rumors, legal matters, security incidents or competitors' products without approval.

Personal social media

- What you post on your own accounts is your own. Make clear you speak for yourself; if you identify as a Simtora employee and discuss Simtora's business or industry, include a disclaimer where appropriate.
 - Do not disclose confidential or customer information, or post content that is harassing, discriminatory, threatening, or that violates law or another Simtora policy.
 - If you have a material connection to Simtora (employee, paid ambassador, referral bonus) and you promote Simtora products, **disclose it clearly** (FTC rules).
 - **Protected activity.** This section does **not** restrict employees from discussing wages, hours or working conditions, acting together for mutual aid or protection, whistleblowing, or any other activity protected by law (see 2.5, HR 1.7).
-

Part 5 – Workplace and Community Responsibility

5.1 Respect, Equal Opportunity and Freedom from Harassment

Purpose. To restate the ethical commitment to a workplace free of discrimination, harassment and retaliation, and to show how Compliance and HR work together.

Policy. Simtora provides equal employment opportunity and prohibits discrimination, harassment (including sexual harassment) and retaliation on the basis of race, color, religion, sex (including pregnancy, sexual orientation and gender identity), national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran or military status, citizenship or immigration status where the law protects it, marital or family status, and any other characteristic protected by federal, state or local law. This applies to hiring, pay, promotion, discipline, termination and every other condition of employment, and to conduct in the office, remote settings, online, at events and when traveling.

- No manager may suggest, expressly or impliedly, that submitting to or rejecting sexual advances will affect anyone's job or pay. Managers must not ask employees who report to them for loans, personal favors or gifts.

- The **detailed rules, complaint process, timescales, investigation and training** are in **HR 3.2** (acknowledgement within 2 business days; aim to conclude in 30 days) and **HR 4.1** (accommodation). The Compliance Officer receives a summary of all complaints and outcomes at least **quarterly** to look for patterns, and reports them to the Audit Committee where the pattern is significant or involves leaders.
 - **Retaliation** for reporting or taking part in a complaint is prohibited and is handled under 2.3.
 - Managers who observe or hear of possible harassment or discrimination must act at once and report to HR within **1 business day** (HR 3.2).
 - Complaints against members of the Executive Team, the Chief People Officer or the General Counsel go to the Audit Committee (2.4).
-

5.2 Human Rights, Forced Labor and Child Labor

Purpose. To make sure that no one is exploited in our business or supply chain, and that we respect internationally recognized human rights.

Policy.

- Simtora prohibits and does not use or knowingly benefit from **forced, bonded, indentured, prison or trafficked labor**, or child labor below the legal minimum age (and in any hazardous work under 18), in its own operations, contractors or supply chain.
- Simtora respects the right of workers to freedom of association and to lawful collective action, pays at least the minimum wage and overtime required by law, and complies with hours and safe-working requirements.
- Simtora complies with the U.S. Tariff Act (Section 307), the **Uyghur Forced Labor Prevention Act** and other import bans on goods made with forced labor, and with the Trafficking Victims Protection Act. Procurement and Facilities must ask hardware and equipment suppliers (including data-center and device vendors) for supply-chain information and follow up on red flags (for example, origins in regions subject to rebuttable presumptions).
- Suppliers must agree to the Supplier and Partner Standards (5.5), including audit and remediation rights, and Procurement includes human-rights terms in contracts.

- If a report or red flag suggests forced or child labor, Procurement stops or pauses the order and refers it to Compliance and Legal, which decide on investigation, remediation or termination. Where federal contracts apply, FAR anti-trafficking clauses are followed.
 - Simtora will not knowingly provide technology that is used to commit human-rights abuses (see 4.3).
 - Concerns about human rights may be reported through any channel in 2.1.
-

5.3 Health, Safety and a Drug-Free Workplace

Purpose. To give a shared ethical commitment to safety and to the requirement that people are fit to work safely.

Policy.

- Simtora is committed to providing a safe and healthy workplace in offices, at home and when traveling, and to complying with OSHA and state and local safety laws.
Nobody's job or results are worth someone's safety. Employees are expected to report unsafe conditions, near misses and injuries right away without fear of retaliation.
 - **Detailed rules** are in **HR 4.3** (health, safety and workplace violence prevention), **HR 4.2** (drug- and alcohol-free workplace, including accommodation of lawful prescription use and support for treatment) and the **Facilities and Office Administration Manual** (SIM-FAC-001, Part 6: emergency plans, fire wardens, first aid and AEDs).
 - Employees must not work while impaired by alcohol, illegal drugs, or misused prescription drugs. Employees may raise a substance-use concern with HR or the Employee Assistance Program without fear of adverse action when seeking help before a policy violation occurs. Testing is limited to what HR 4.2 and applicable state law permit; there is no blanket testing.
 - **Workplace violence and threats** are never tolerated. Report a threat of violence, weapons or emergencies immediately to security or 911, then to HR (HR 4.3).
-

5.4 Environmental Responsibility

Purpose. To reduce Simtora's environmental impact and comply with environmental laws.

Policy.

- Simtora complies with applicable environmental laws and permits, including those on **electronic waste, batteries, hazardous materials and refrigerants** at offices and data spaces, and on chemical and waste disposal.
 - IT asset disposal uses certified recyclers and secure sanitization (IT 2.4), and produces a certificate of destruction or recycling. Devices are reused or refurbished where security permits.
 - Simtora considers energy efficiency and carbon intensity when choosing **cloud regions, data-center and infrastructure providers**, and when designing software (for example, efficient code and right-sizing). Procurement asks key vendors about their environmental commitments and the IT team tracks cloud usage and cost as a proxy for footprint.
 - Facilities implements recycling, waste reduction and energy-saving measures in offices (see the Facilities and Office Administration Manual, SIM-FAC-001, 6.9).
 - Public claims about sustainability, carbon neutrality or "green" products are reviewed by Legal and must be truthful and substantiated (FTC Green Guides; state laws) (see 3.2).
 - **Climate disclosure laws.** Legal monitors state and federal climate-related disclosure requirements (for example, California SB 253 and SB 261) and determines annually whether Simtora meets any threshold; if so, the CFO and General Counsel own the required reporting.
 - Employees are encouraged to suggest ways to reduce waste and energy use.
-

5.5 Supplier and Partner Standards

Purpose. To make sure vendors, contractors, resellers and other partners meet the same standards of ethics that Simtora sets for itself.

Policy.

- Procurement includes the **Supplier and Partner Standards** (a short code published by Compliance) in vendor terms and onboarding. It requires suppliers to: comply with

law; not offer or accept bribes; disclose conflicts of interest; protect data and confidential information; respect human rights and prohibit forced and child labor; provide safe workplaces; comply with sanctions and export laws; keep accurate records; allow reasonable audit; and report concerns through Simtora's Ethics Line, which is open to suppliers.

- Vendors are selected on merit, price, quality and risk, through fair and documented processes. **No favoritism.** Anyone with a conflict about a vendor must step aside (3.5). Gifts from bidders are not accepted (3.4).
 - Due diligence, risk tiering and monitoring follow 6.5 (compliance) and IT 8.1 (security). Commercial rules (approval thresholds, tenders, renewals) are in the Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001, Parts 3 and 5).
 - Serious breaches of the Standards may lead to remediation requirements, suspension or termination, and referral to authorities where required.
 - Simtora aims to pay undisputed invoices on agreed terms and to treat suppliers, including small and diverse businesses, fairly.
-

5.6 Community and Volunteering

Purpose. To support employees' involvement in their communities while keeping it separate from business favors.

Policy.

- Simtora encourages volunteering and charitable giving. Paid volunteer time is described in HR 7.3.
 - Company-sponsored volunteer activities are open to everyone and are not used to entertain, reward or influence customers or officials (see 3.8).
 - Employees who volunteer or serve on non-profit boards in a personal capacity must make clear they do not represent Simtora, and disclose the role if it could create a conflict (3.5).
 - Donations and sponsorships follow 3.8.
-

Part 6 – Running the Compliance Program

6.1 Legal Requirements Register and Risk Assessment

Purpose. To know what laws and commitments apply to Simtora and to focus effort where the risk is highest.

Legal Requirements Register

- The **General Counsel** maintains a register of the laws, regulations, contractual duties and voluntary standards that apply to Simtora, mapped to a business owner and the policy or control that addresses each. It covers at least: anti-corruption, antitrust, sanctions and export controls, privacy and data security, breach notification, consumer protection and advertising, employment, government contracting, securities and corporate law, tax, IP and open source, AI-specific laws, and environmental and safety laws.
- The register is reviewed at least **annually**, and immediately when Simtora enters a new state, country, customer sector or product type, or when a major law changes. The IT manual's legal-obligation table (IT 1.4) is one input.
- Owners must confirm each year that their controls address their entries.

Annual compliance risk assessment

Step	Detail
1. Identify	Compliance, Legal and business leaders identify risks by function, product, geography, customer type (public sector vs. commercial), third parties and new laws.
2. Rate	Each risk is rated on likelihood and impact (High / Medium / Low), taking into account past incidents, audit results, Ethics Line trends, industry enforcement and complaints.
3. Respond	Compliance sets the annual compliance plan : controls, training focus, monitoring and testing, resources.
4. Approve	The Compliance Committee reviews and the Audit Committee approves the plan by January 31 each year.
5. Update	Reassessed mid-year and after major events.

Risk areas at Simtora include: revenue recognition and deal terms; government and public-sector sales; third-party sales partners; privacy and AI; export controls for software and encryption; sanctions screening for cloud customers; open-source license compliance; anti-poaching and information sharing with competitors; and expense and procurement fraud.

6.2 Training and Communication

Purpose. To make sure everyone knows the rules that apply to them, and how to ask and report.

Required training

Training	Who	When
Code of Ethics and Compliance (this manual in brief; Speak Up; non-retaliation)	Everyone	Within 30 days of hire , then annually
Anti-harassment and anti-discrimination (as required by state law, with supervisor content)		

Other communication

- **Tone from the top.** The CEO and Executive Team state their commitment to ethics at least **twice a year** (all-hands or written message).
- **Short reminders.** Compliance sends regular short messages, scenarios and quizzes (at least **quarterly**).
- **Just-in-time guidance.** Templates and checklists are available on the intranet (for example, the gift request form and the customer-screening checklist).
- **Plain language.** Training uses realistic scenarios from technology work (see Appendix G).

Completion and consequences

- Compliance tracks completion and gives managers weekly reports. Training not complete by the due date is escalated to the manager after **7 days**, to the Department Head after **14 days**, and may lead to loss of system access after **30 days** (with HR and IT), or corrective action for repeated failure.
 - Training content is reviewed annually and updated for new laws and lessons learned. Records are kept for 7 years.
-

6.3 Certification and Annual Disclosure

Purpose. To confirm that everyone has read, understands and will follow the Code, and to keep conflict information current.

- **At hire.** New employees, contractors and interns complete the Code Certification (Appendix A) and a conflict disclosure (Appendix B) within **30 days of hire** (with the HR acknowledgement in HR Appendix A).
- **Annual.** Every employee and director recertifies each year in a campaign that opens in **January** and closes within **30 days**. The certification includes: the Code has been read and understood; compliance with it; any issue to report; and updated disclosure of conflicts, outside activities and gifts above the thresholds.
- **On change.** Disclosures must be updated within **30 days** of a change, or immediately if it affects a decision being made.

- **Officers and higher-risk roles** (Executive Team, Finance, Procurement, Sales leaders, employees dealing with government) also complete a **detailed questionnaire** annually covering financial interests in vendors, customers and competitors, related parties, outside directorships, gifts, and any knowledge of misconduct.
- **Directors** provide an annual disclosure to the Audit Committee about related parties and transactions.
- **Non-completion.** Follows the escalation in 6.2. A person who signs a false certification is in breach of this manual.
- **Effect on employment.** The certification is a term of ongoing employment, consistent with HR (see HR 1.2). It does not waive any right in 2.5.

6.4 Monitoring, Testing and Audit

Purpose. To check that the program works in practice, not just on paper.

Activity	What	Who	Frequency
Controls testing	Test key financial and compliance controls (approvals, segregation of duties, gift and conflict processes, screening, expense checks)	Finance, Compliance (with internal audit or an outside firm)	At least annually; high-risk controls semi-annually
Transaction monitoring	Data analytics on payments, expenses, vendor master changes, discounts, third-party commissions, unusual timing or amounts, duplicates and split purchases	Finance and Compliance	Quarterly, or continuous for high-risk
Register reviews	Gifts, conflicts, outside activities, related parties	Compliance	Quarterly (gifts), at least annually (conflicts)

Findings are logged with an owner and due date, tracked to closure, and reported to the Compliance Committee and Audit Committee. High-severity findings are reported to the General Counsel within **2 business days**.

6.5 Third-Party Due Diligence

Purpose. To manage the risk that third parties acting for Simtora, or connected to our business, expose us to corruption, sanctions, privacy, human-rights or reputation risk. This section covers the compliance layer; IT 8.1 covers the security layer; the Procurement Policy Manual (SIM-PRC-001) covers the commercial process.

Scope. Sales agents, resellers, distributors, channel partners, consultants, lobbyists, customs and logistics providers, subcontractors, joint-venture and teaming partners, and critical vendors.

Risk tiers

Tier	Typical third parties	Due diligence	Refresh
High	Anyone who deals with government officials for us; agents or resellers in high-risk countries; those paid on commission or success fees; lobbyists; vendors in sanctions-sensitive countries; critical vendors with access to Restricted data	Full questionnaire (Appendix E); ownership and beneficial owners; screening (sanctions, PEP, adverse media); references; interview by Compliance; Compliance and General Counsel approval ; contract clauses; training	Every 12 months , plus on any trigger
Medium	Resellers and partners in the U.S. and low-risk countries; consultants with access to customers; vendors with Confidential data	Short questionnaire; screening; Compliance review; standard clauses	

Steps

1. The **business owner** submits the third party for review **before** any commitment or payment (through the vendor onboarding workflow; see Procurement Policy Manual, 4.1).
 2. Compliance assigns a tier, collects information, screens names and owners (sanctions and restricted-party lists, politically exposed persons, adverse media), and resolves red flags.
 3. **Contract terms** for Medium and High: anti-corruption, sanctions, data protection and Supplier and Partner Standards compliance; accurate records; audit rights; termination for breach; no subcontracting or sub-agents without approval; payment only to named accounts in the party's own name, in the country where services are performed, and against invoices detailing actual services.
 4. **Compensation review.** Commissions, success fees and unusually high rates need documented justification, benchmarking and approval by the Department Head, Compliance Officer and CFO.
 5. **Monitoring.** Payments are reviewed against the contract; the business owner reports red flags immediately; Compliance reviews high-risk parties on the refresh cycle and conducts periodic audits.
 6. **Termination.** Legal and Compliance decide on suspension or termination where a serious concern is confirmed, and document the reasons.
-

6.6 Regulatory Inquiries, Subpoenas and Government Investigations

Purpose. To make sure Simtora responds lawfully, consistently and promptly when a government agency or a court contacts us.

Scope. Any request from a regulator, law enforcement, agency, legislature, court or opposing party for information or access, whether by letter, email, phone, subpoena, search warrant, civil investigative demand, or visit to a Simtora location or employee's home.

Rules

1. **Notify Legal immediately** (within **1 hour** for a search warrant, visit or agent contact; otherwise the **same business day**) of any government inquiry, subpoena, request for information, or contact about Simtora business. Do not respond, provide documents or answer questions until Legal has been consulted, unless the law or an emergency requires it.
 2. **Be polite and cooperative.** Simtora cooperates with lawful requests, through Legal, and never obstructs.
 3. **Do not destroy, alter or hide** any records (see 4.4). Legal will issue a hold.
 4. **Tell the truth.** Never lie to or mislead a government official. False statements to federal officials are a crime (18 U.S.C. § 1001).
 5. **Search warrants and unannounced visits.** Receptionists and site staff ask for identification and the warrant, call Legal at once, be courteous, do not interfere, and do not consent to a broader search than the warrant authorizes. Legal or outside counsel attends where possible. Remote employees who receive a visit at home follow the same steps.
 6. **Employee rights.** Employees **may** speak to government investigators, and **may not** be told not to. Employees have the right to talk to an attorney first, and to have counsel present. Simtora will tell employees, on request, that they can speak with Legal or arrange separate counsel where appropriate. The Company will not prevent anyone from lawfully reporting or cooperating (see 2.5). Employees are asked, but not required, to tell Legal about contact so the Company can respond correctly. Do not pressure or coach others on what to say.
 7. **Privilege.** Communications with Legal are privileged. Do not forward them or discuss them outside the group that needs to know.
 8. **Customer requests for user data.** Requests from law enforcement for customer or user data are handled only by Legal under the law-enforcement request procedure, with notice to the customer where lawful and contractually required.
 9. **Log and coordinate.** Legal logs every inquiry, decides on the response and reports material ones to the CEO and Audit Committee.
-

6.7 Waivers, Exceptions and Amendments

Purpose. To make clear when a rule in this manual may be waived, who can waive it, and how changes are made.

Waivers

- Waivers of this manual are **rare**. No waiver is allowed for anything the law prohibits, or for provisions on non-retaliation, protected rights (2.5), anti-bribery (3.3), sanctions (3.7) or records tampering (4.4).
- Any other waiver must be in **writing**, state the reason, conditions and the period (not more than **12 months**), and be recorded in the waiver register kept by Compliance.

Person seeking waiver	Approved by
Employee, contractor	General Counsel or Compliance Officer, with the Department Head
Department Head or Executive Team member (except the CEO)	General Counsel and CEO
CEO, directors, executive officers, General Counsel, CFO, Compliance Officer	The Audit Committee (or the Board), disclosed as the law or a customer or lender agreement requires

- Waivers for executive officers and directors are **disclosed** to the Board at its next meeting, and to shareholders, lenders or regulators as required.

Amendments

- Compliance recommends changes to this manual at least annually and when the law or business changes. The General Counsel approves minor changes and the **CEO** approves substantive changes, informing the Audit Committee at its next meeting.
 - Every version is recorded in Appendix K and published on the intranet with notice to employees. Material changes require re-acknowledgement (6.3).
-

6.8 Accountability and Discipline

Purpose. To make sure that violations have fair and consistent consequences and that good conduct is rewarded.

Accountability

- Everyone who violates law, this manual or Company policy, or who **fails to report** a violation they knew of, directs or pressures others to violate, retaliates, or obstructs an investigation, is subject to **corrective action up to and including termination**, using the process in **HR 2.3**. Contractors and third parties face termination of their engagement.
- Managers are accountable for violations in their teams that they knew of, or should have known of, or for creating pressure that led to them.
- Consequences are **consistent** regardless of seniority, performance or business value. Compliance and HR review corrective action for comparable cases across the Company at least **annually** for consistency and fairness.
- The Company may also seek to recover losses, report to authorities, and (as the law permits) claw back incentive compensation, including in the case of misconduct that leads to a financial restatement.

Factors considered

Seriousness and harm; intent; whether it was self-reported; cooperation; whether the person was pressured or misled; prior history; training completed; and whether it involved a person with authority.

Recognition

- Ethical behavior is part of **performance reviews** for everyone (HR 2.1), and conduct standards are a factor in promotion and incentive decisions. Managers are not rewarded for results achieved through violations.
- Compliance recognizes employees who raise concerns, prevent problems or improve controls (for example, in the annual recognition program in HR 7.3), without disclosing confidential reporters.

6.9 Reporting to Leadership and the Board

Purpose. To give leaders and the Board the information they need to oversee the program.

Report	Contents	To	Frequency
Ethics Line and case report	New reports by category, number open and closed, time to close (against 2.4 targets), substantiation rate, retaliation reports, outcomes, and lessons	Compliance Committee; Audit Committee	Quarterly (serious matters at once)
Compliance dashboard	Training and certification completion; conflicts and gifts activity; third-party due diligence status; screening results; privacy requests and incidents; AI reviews; audit findings and overdue actions	Compliance Committee; Audit Committee	Quarterly
Serious incident alert	Fraud, bribery, sanctions, senior-leader misconduct, government inquiry, data breach with notification, retaliation for reporting	CEO and Audit Committee chair	Within 24 hours of triage
Annual compliance plan and risk assessment	See 6.1	Audit Committee (approval)	Annually, by January 31
Annual program report	Program effectiveness, metrics, key risks, incidents, resources, and results of the annual review of this manual	Audit Committee and Board; summary to the Executive Team	Annually
Private sessions	Audit Committee meets the Compliance Officer and General Counsel without management	Audit Committee	At least twice a year

Appendix A – Code Certification Form

Complete at hire (within 30 days) and annually (within 30 days of the campaign opening).
Also available in the compliance portal.

Field	Entry
Name, employee ID, department, manager	
Location (state or country)	
Version of the Code Certified	SIM-CMP-001 v____

Certification. I confirm that:

1. I have received, read and understand the Simtora Code of Ethics and Compliance Manual (SIM-CMP-001) and the parts that apply to my role, and I know where to find it.
2. I will comply with the Code, the law, and Company policies, and I understand that doing so is a condition of my continued employment or engagement. Violations may lead to corrective action up to and including termination.
3. I understand my duty to report suspected violations promptly and that I can do so through my manager, HR, Compliance, Legal, the Ethics Line (ethics@simtora.example), or the Audit Committee (audit@simtora.example).
4. I understand that Simtora prohibits retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith or takes part in an investigation.
5. I understand that nothing in the Code or in any Company agreement stops me from reporting to or cooperating with a government agency, discussing pay and working conditions, or exercising other legally protected rights (see 2.5).
6. To the best of my knowledge, I have complied with the Code during the past year, **except as described below.**
7. I have disclosed to Compliance (Appendix B) every actual or potential conflict of interest and every outside activity, financial interest, gift or relationship that the Code requires me to disclose, **except as described below.**

Exceptions, concerns or issues to disclose (attach pages if needed; write "none" if none)	

Signature (or electronic acknowledgement)	Date

Appendix B – Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form

Field	Entry
Name, title, department, manager	
Type of disclosure (New / Update / Annual confirmation / None to report)	
Category (financial interest; family or personal relationship; outside work or business; board or advisory role; corporate opportunity; investment; gift or favor; government connection; other)	
Description of the interest or activity: who, what, since when	
Entity or person involved (name, relationship to you, relationship to Simtora: customer, vendor, competitor, partner, none)	
Size or value of the interest (ownership percentage, income, hours per week)	
Any Simtora decision or process in which you are, or could be, involved that relates to this (purchases, hiring, pricing, contracts, access to information)	
Does it use Simtora time, equipment, information or IP? (Yes / No)	
Proposed steps to manage it (for example recusal, no involvement, restricted access)	
Manager's comments	
For Compliance use: Register number, decision (no action / managed / restricted / not permitted), management plan, decision maker, date (target within 10 business days), review date	

I confirm that this information is complete and accurate, and will update it if anything changes.

Signature / date: _____

Appendix C – Gift, Meal and Entertainment Request and Log

Use for anything given or received above the "no approval" limits in 3.4, or anything of any value involving a government official (approval needed **before** giving).

Field	Entry
Given or received? Date (or planned date)	
Your name, department, manager	
Recipient / giver: name, organization, role	
Is the recipient or giver a government official or employee of a government-owned or controlled entity? (Yes / No / Not sure)	
Description and estimated value per person (US\$); number of attendees	
Total value this calendar year from/to this source (including this item)	
Business purpose	
Any active tender, negotiation, renewal, audit or regulatory matter involving this party? (Yes / No)	
Was it solicited? (Yes / No)	
Approvals required (per 3.4): Department Head / Compliance Officer / General Counsel	
Approver name, decision, date	
Outcome for received gifts above limit (declined / returned / shared / donated / accepted for the Company)	
Expense claim number (if any)	

Compliance keeps the gift register and reviews it quarterly.

Appendix D – Ethics Concern Intake Form

Use this to prepare a report, or paste it into an email to ethics@simtora.example, or use the secure web form. You may stay anonymous. **You do not need to answer every question.**

Field	Entry
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Appendix E – Third-Party Due Diligence Checklist

#	Item	Tier (H/M/L)	Done
1	Business need, scope of services and why this party was chosen (with any alternatives considered)	H, M	
2	Legal name, registration, address, website, years in business, countries of operation	H, M, L	
3	Ownership and beneficial owners (25% or more; any government ownership or officials as owners, directors or family)	H, M	
4	Key personnel and their relationships with government officials, Simtora employees or customers	H	
5	Screening completed: sanctions and restricted-party lists, PEP, adverse media, debarment (SAM.gov and state lists), litigation	H, M, L	
6	Reputation and references; history of investigations, enforcement or corruption allegations	H, M	
7	Compensation structure and justification (rate benchmark; commission or success fee approved; payment account in the party's own name and country)	H, M	
8	Anti-corruption, ethics and sanctions program (policies, training, hotline); questionnaire responses	H, M	
9	Data protection and security review (IT 8.1), including personal data handled and sub-processors	H, M	
10	Human rights and labor practices (for hardware, manufacturing or logistics suppliers)	H, M	
11			

Red flags: high or unusual fees, cash or third-country payment requests, official referral, refusal to sign compliance terms, unexplained ownership, poor reputation, vague services, pressure to skip diligence, or request to hide the party's involvement.

Appendix F – Investigation Checklist

#	Step	Owner	Done / date
1	Log the report, assign the case number, conflicts check on everyone involved in handling it	Compliance Officer	
2	Acknowledge receipt (within 5 business days)	Compliance Officer	
3	Triage severity; decide who investigates; escalate serious matters within 24 hours (2.4)	Compliance Officer, General Counsel	
4	Decide whether to issue a legal hold and involve IT for preservation (4.4)	General Counsel	
5	Urgent protective measures for the reporter and witnesses (no retaliation; review pending employment decisions)	HR, Compliance	
6	Investigation plan: allegations, scope, evidence sources, people to interview, privilege, timeline	Investigator	
7	Collect and preserve evidence; device and account access approved (IT 4.8; General Counsel and Chief People Officer)	Investigator, IT	
8	Interviews: explain role, confidentiality, non-retaliation and no obstruction; take notes; give the subject a chance to respond	Investigator	
9	Analyze evidence against the standard (more likely than not)		

Appendix G – Working Through Ethical Dilemmas (Q&A)

These examples show how the rules apply. They are guidance, not a complete list. When in doubt, ask.

1. A prospective customer's procurement director hints that a "consulting fee" paid to their brother's firm would help our bid succeed. What should I do? Decline. That is likely a bribe or kickback, and applies to private and public buyers. Do not discuss it further, do not promise anything, and report it to Compliance within **1 business day** (3.3). Do not continue the deal until Compliance responds.

****2. A vendor sends me a**

300 gift basket at the holiday season. I have already renewed their contract for two years. *

***Report it to Compliance within 5 business days.** Gifts above 50 need approval and this is over \$250, so it needs Department Head and Compliance approval to keep. Usually it is politely returned with an explanation, or the perishable items are shared with the team (3.4). The timing of the contract does not change the rule.

3. My cousin owns a small firm that would be perfect to provide contractors for our project. Can I bring them in? Disclose the relationship in writing to your manager and Compliance before you act (3.5). You must not take part in selecting, evaluating or approving the firm. Procurement runs the usual process, and Compliance decides whether the firm can bid.

4. At an industry conference, a competitor's sales lead says, "We are both raising prices next quarter, so let's not undercut each other." What do I do? Say clearly that you will not discuss pricing, end the conversation and leave. Then tell Legal the same day (3.6). Silence can be read as agreement, and price coordination is a crime even without a written agreement.

5. A recruiter at a partner company suggests we agree not to hire each other's engineers. Decline and tell Legal. No-poach agreements between employers can be criminal (3.6), unless Legal approved a narrow arrangement as part of a legitimate collaboration.

- 6. It is quarter end. My manager asks me to add a signed side letter with a customer, promising a free extension and cancellation rights, but not to send it to Finance.** Do not sign, and report it. Undisclosed side terms can make revenue reporting false (3.1, 3.2). Raise it with Finance, Legal or Compliance, or use the Ethics Line. You are protected from retaliation for refusing (2.3).
- 7. A potential customer in a country we do not serve asks to pay through an account in a third country, and to get access through a reseller.** Stop and contact Legal and Finance before any further steps. This may be a sanctions or money-laundering red flag (3.7). Do not tell the customer that Simtora is checking anything beyond ordinary onboarding.
- 8. A new engineer in another country needs access to encryption source code for a product.** Check with Legal first. Sharing controlled technology with a foreign national or in another country can be an export ("deemed export") that requires classification or a license (3.7).
- 9. I got an email from a government agency with a document request about a customer contract.** Do not respond. Forward it to Legal immediately, and keep all related records (6.6, 4.4). Legal will issue a hold and coordinate the response.
- 10. I'm on the state government sales team. A friend at the agency invites me to lunch after we submitted a bid, and offers to share how our proposal is scored.** Do not attend lunch or accept any information. Receiving non-public procurement information is prohibited. Report the offer to Legal at once (3.9).
- 11. Our AI tool for ranking job applicants seems to favor some groups. Should I speak up?** Yes. Report it to HR, Compliance or the Ethics Line. HR, Legal and the AI Review Board will review and pause the tool if needed, test for bias, and follow the required notices (4.3). Do not wait for someone else to notice.
- 12. While working for a customer, I saw internal information that suggests their earnings will beat expectations. Can I buy their stock?** No. That is potentially material non-public information (3.10). Do not trade and do not tip anyone. If you have questions, ask Legal before trading.
- 13. I reported my manager for a policy violation and now my schedule and projects have changed.** Report this to HR, Compliance or the Ethics Line immediately. Retaliation is prohibited, and any adverse change after a report gets special review (2.3).

14. I want to post about our pay and working conditions in an online group and to talk to a government agency about a workplace issue. Do I need approval? No. Nothing in the Code restricts these protected rights (2.5, 4.5). You still should not share customer data or trade secrets.

15. I made a mistake that caused a customer's data to be visible to another customer for an hour. I am afraid to say anything. Report it now to security (security@simtora.example) under IT 7.4. Early reporting is part of the fix and is treated as a positive. Legal will decide on notification (4.1). Hiding an incident is a serious violation.

Appendix H – Approval Matrix

Decision or action	Requester / owner	Approver(s)
Adoption or substantive change to this manual	General Counsel	CEO (Audit Committee informed)
Annual compliance plan and risk assessment	Compliance Officer	Compliance Committee; Audit Committee
Waiver of the Code – employee or contractor	Employee	General Counsel or Compliance Officer, with the Department Head
Waiver of the Code – Department Head or Executive Team	Requester	General Counsel and CEO
Waiver of the Code – CEO, director, executive officer, General Counsel, CFO, Compliance Officer	Requester	Audit Committee (or Board)
Gift or hospitality above 50upto250 (private sector)	Employee	Department Head (logged)
Gift or hospitality above \$250	Employee	Department Head and Compliance Officer
Gift or hospitality above \$1,000		

Appendix I – Key Standards at a Glance

Topic	Standard	Section
Report suspected violations	Promptly; managers pass on within 1 business day	1.2, 2.1
Compliance question response	Routine within 2 business days	1.3
Ethics Line report logged	Within 2 business days	2.4
Acknowledge a report	Within 5 business days	2.4
Serious matters to CEO and Audit Committee chair	Within 24 hours of triage	2.4, 6.9
Investigation target	45 days (90 days if complex)	2.4
Harassment complaints	Acknowledge in 2 business days; aim to conclude in 30 days	HR 3.2, 5.1
Retaliation safeguard	HR and Compliance review of adverse action within 12 months of a report	2.3
Gifts (no approval)	Up to \$50 per source per year; never cash or equivalents	3.4
Meals and entertainment (no approval)	Meals up to 100 (<i>4 per source per year</i>); <i>entertainment up to 150</i> (2 per source per year)	3.4
Gifts to or from government officials	Compliance approval for any value	3.3, 3.4

tender or negotiation	None	3.4
Facilitation payments	Prohibited	3.3
Conflict disclosure	In writing before acting; decision within 10 business days	3.5
Related-party transactions	Over \$10,000 a year need Audit Committee review	3.5
Public company stock held without conflict	Under 1% (or diversified funds)	3.5
Competitor contact on prices, bids, wages, hiring	None; report to Legal same day	3.6
Cash payments accepted	None over \$1,000; report suspicious payments	3.7
Sanctions screening	Before contract; at least annually for high-risk parties	3.7
Export and sanctions records	5 years	3.7, 4.4
Charitable donation	\$5,000 Department Head; above that CEO and General Counsel	3.8
Privacy requests	Acknowledge in 10 business days; respond in 45 days	4.1
Breach notice clocks	Legal tracks; GDPR 72 hours; contracts typically 72 hours; states vary	4.1
Legal hold	Issued within 2 business days; IT implements within 1 business day	4.4
Default email retention	3 years	4.4
Ethics and case records retention	7 years	2.2, 4.4

Certification	At hire (30 days); annually (opens January, 30 days to complete)	6.3
Government contact	Legal notified same day; within 1 hour for warrants and visits	6.6
Waiver maximum	12 months	6.7
Third-party diligence refresh	High 12 months; Medium 24 months	6.5
Compliance Committee	Quarterly	1.4
Independent program review	At least every 2 years	6.4

Appendix J – Glossary

Term	Meaning
Anything of value	Anything a person might find useful or desirable: cash, gifts, meals, travel, entertainment, jobs, loans, discounts, donations, favors, and more; no minimum amount
Audit Committee	The committee of the Board responsible for financial reporting, controls, audit, and oversight of the compliance program and Ethics Line
Bribery	Offering, giving, requesting or accepting anything of value to improperly influence a decision or reward improper conduct
Compliance Committee	Management committee, chaired by the General Counsel, that oversees the day-to-day compliance program
Compliance Officer	The manager who runs the compliance program, reporting to the General Counsel and with direct access to the Audit Committee
Conflict of interest	A personal interest that could influence, or appear to influence, your judgment or duty to Simtora
Deemed export	Release of controlled technology or source code to a foreign person in the U.S., treated as an export to that person's home country
EAR / ITAR	Export Administration Regulations (Commerce) / International Traffic in Arms Regulations (State)
Ethics Line	The confidential reporting channel (ethics@simtora.example and web form), which accepts anonymous reports
FCPA	U.S. Foreign Corrupt Practices Act: anti-bribery of foreign officials, and accounting requirements
False Claims Act	Federal law penalizing false claims for payment by the government, with treble damages
Facilitation payment	A small payment to speed up a routine government action; prohibited by Simtora

Appendix K – Revision History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of changes	Approved by
1.0	September 30, 2026	General Counsel and Compliance Officer	Initial release	CEO
1.1	October 5, 2026	General Counsel and Compliance Officer	Scope extended to all employees in all countries; added "Locations outside the United States"; amended travel/work-location rule; cross-references to SIM-GLB-001 Part 2	CEO

Annual review record: record the date and reviewer of each annual review here, even where no changes were made.